

Storyboarding

Why do we need stories in design?

Stories help explain the experience of something to someone who hasn't experienced it before.

Three ways of telling stories in design:

- **Scenarios**

- A short story about a specific user with a specific goal
- Written accounts and narratives of the experience
- Analogy: Books

- **Storyboards**

- A series of drawn panels showing how a user might progress through a task in a system
- Visual storytelling with rough sketches/cartoons
- Analogy: Comics, Picture books

- **Video Storyboards**

- Richer visual storytelling
- Analogy: Movies/TV



<https://www.commoncraft.com/video/twitter>

Storytelling

- Stories have an **audience**
 - Other designers, clients, stakeholders, managers, funding agencies, potential end-users
- Stories have a **purpose**
 - Gather and share information about people, tasks, goals
 - Put a human face on analytic data
 - Spark new design concepts and encourage innovation
 - Share ideas and create a sense of history and purpose
 - Giving insight into people who are not like us
 - Persuade others of the value of contribution

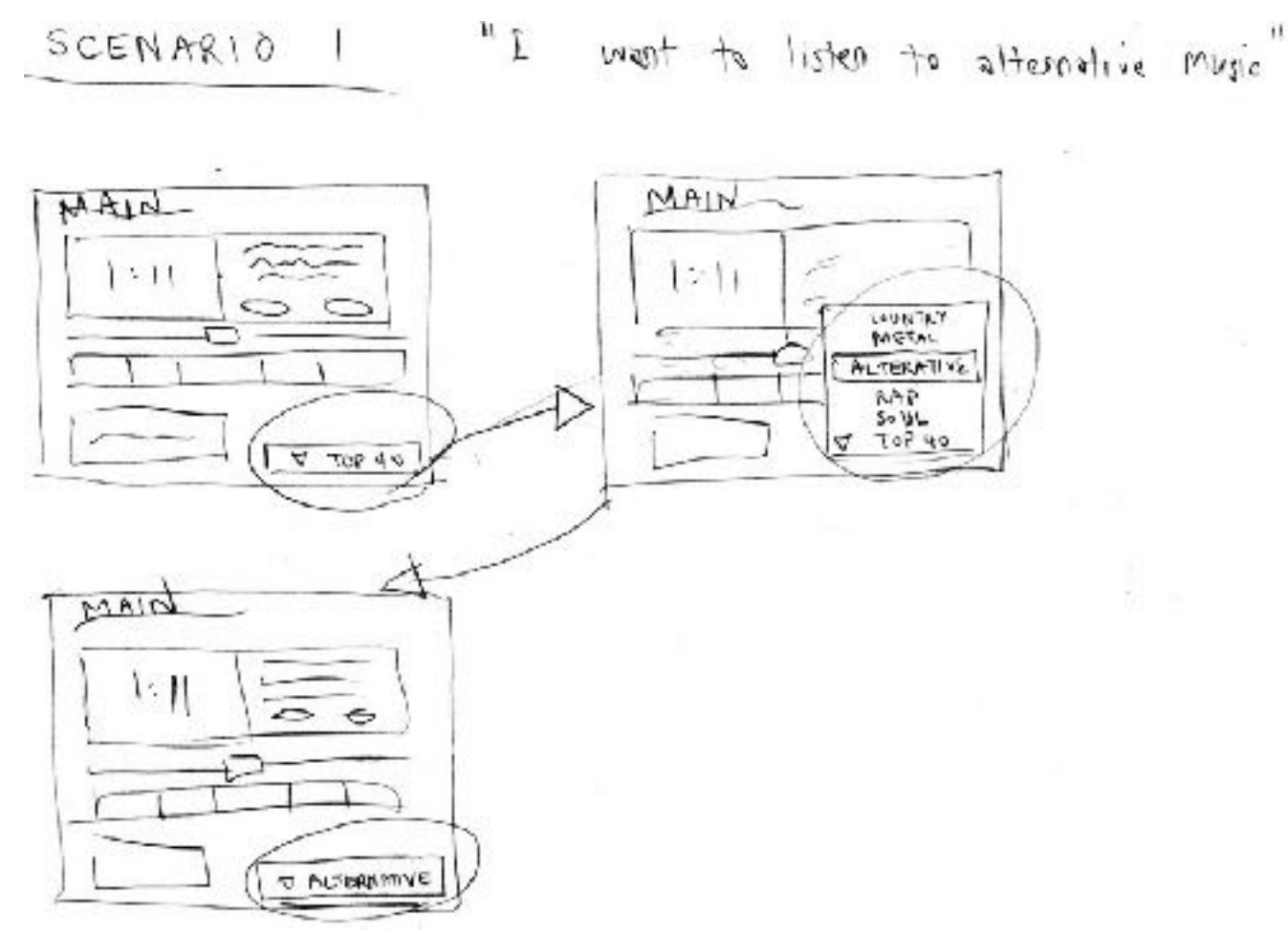
Stories Provide Context

- Characters
 - Who is involved
- Setting
 - Environment
- Sequence
 - What task is being accomplished
 - What leads a person to use your technology
 - What steps are involved
- Satisfaction
 - What is the motivation for the user?
 - What is the end result?
 - What need are you satisfying?

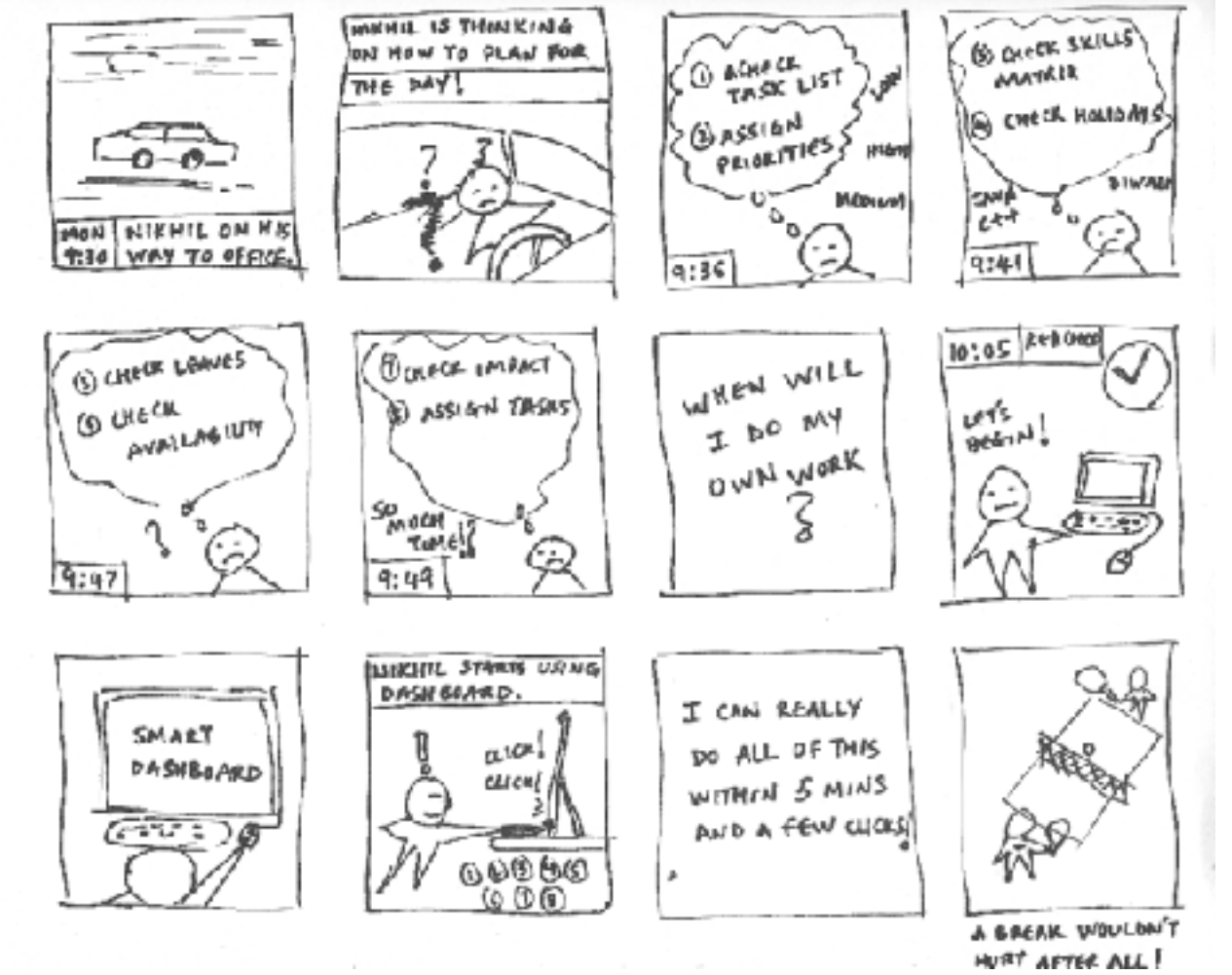
2a



2e

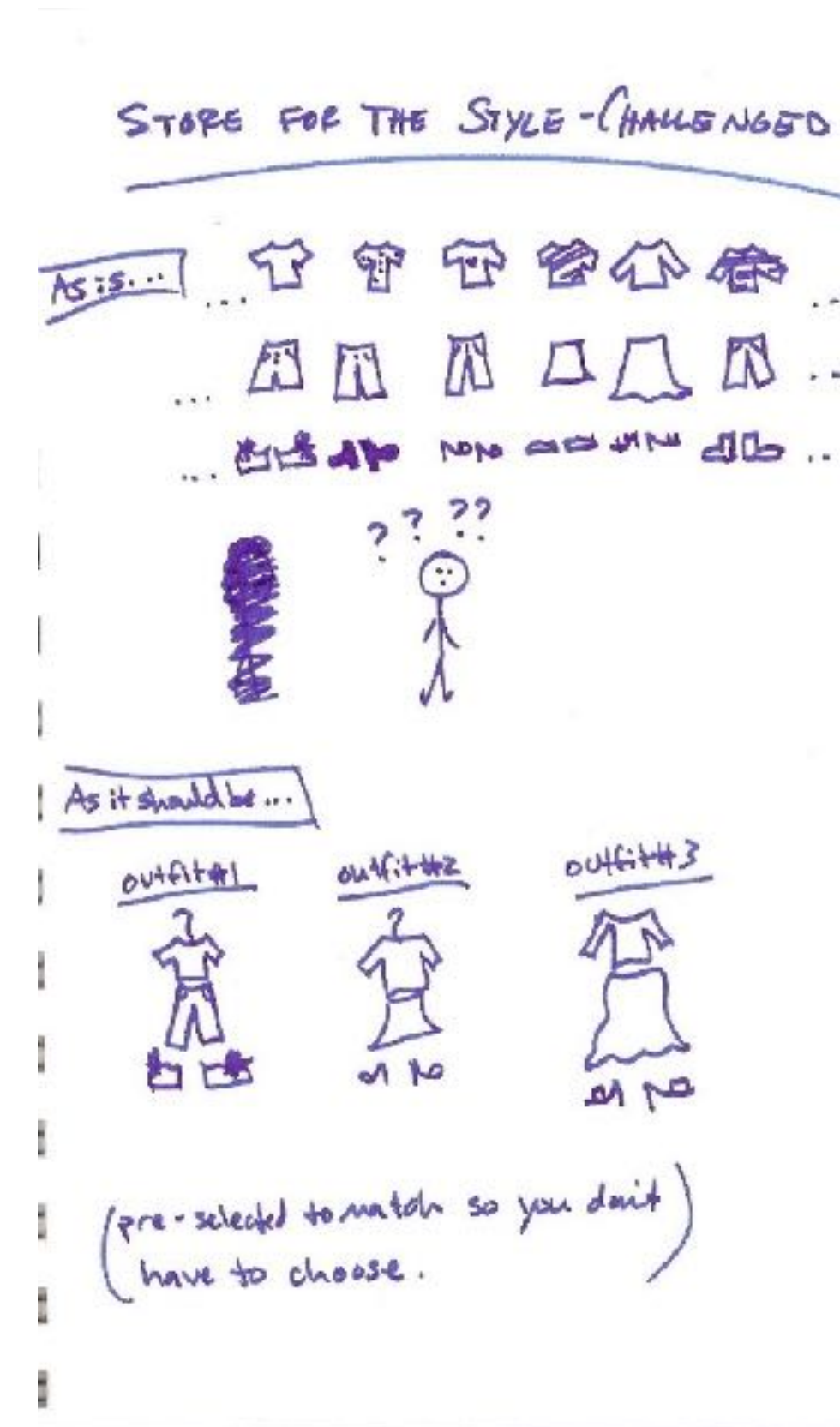
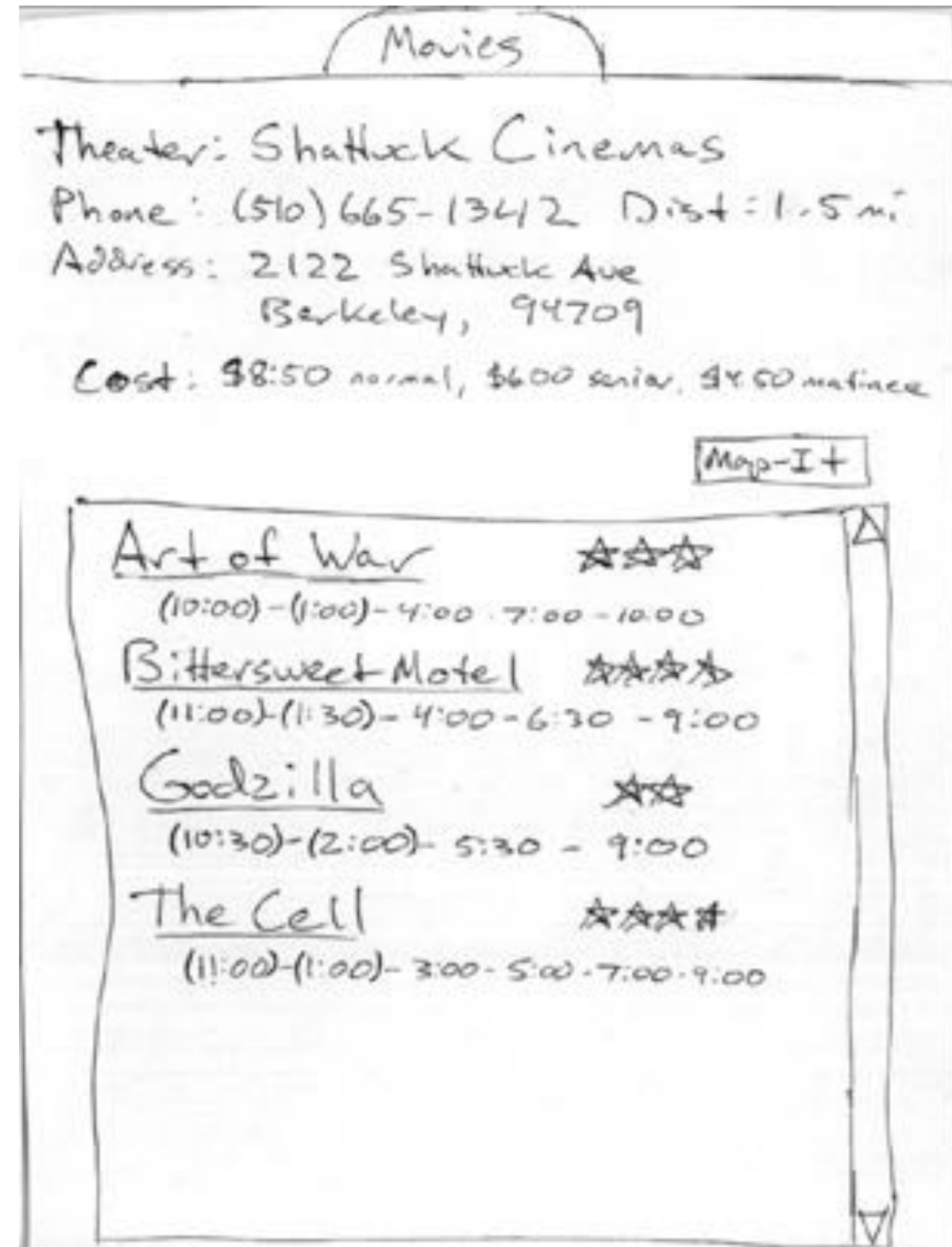


2f



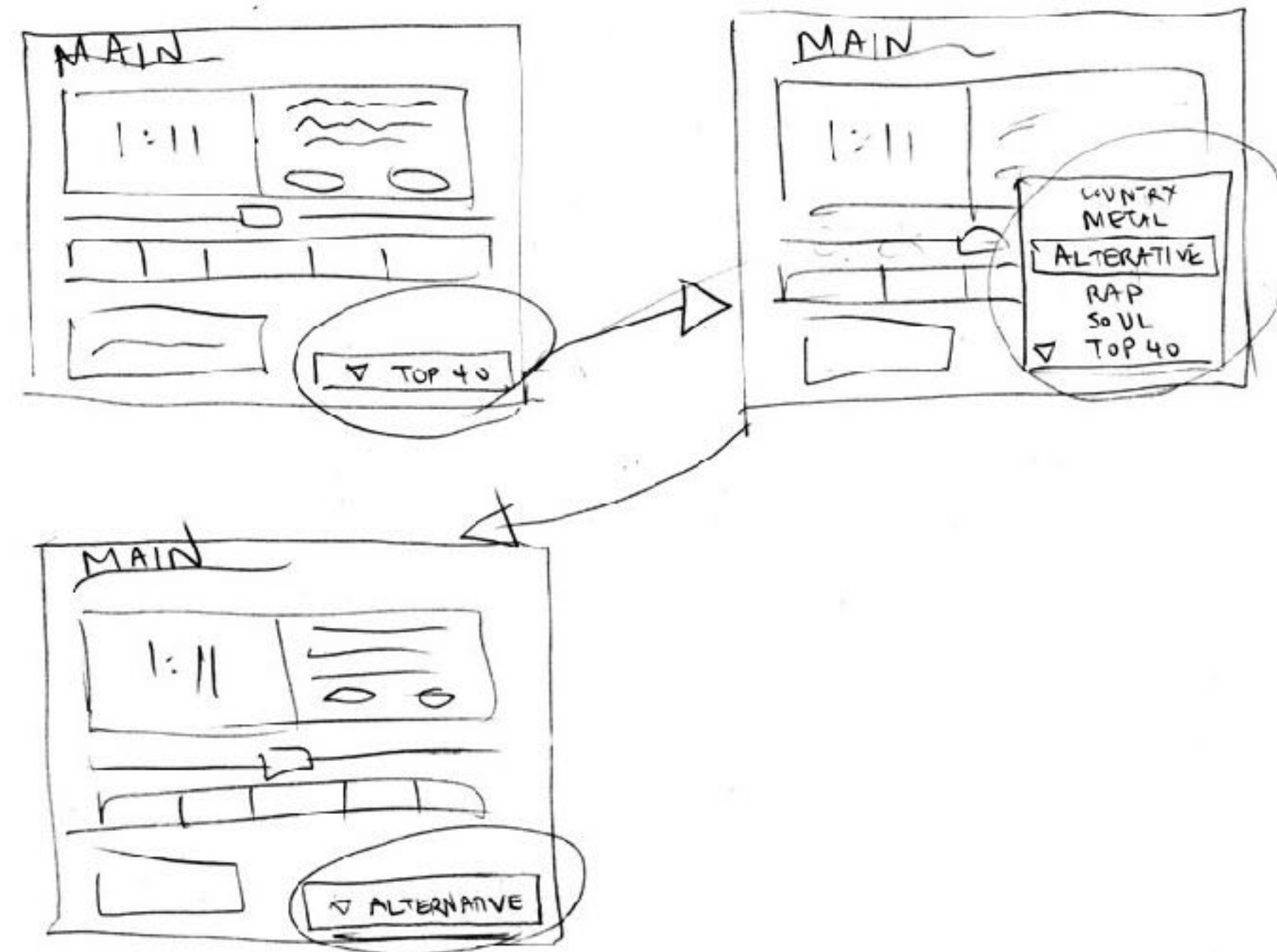
Sketch —————> Storyboard

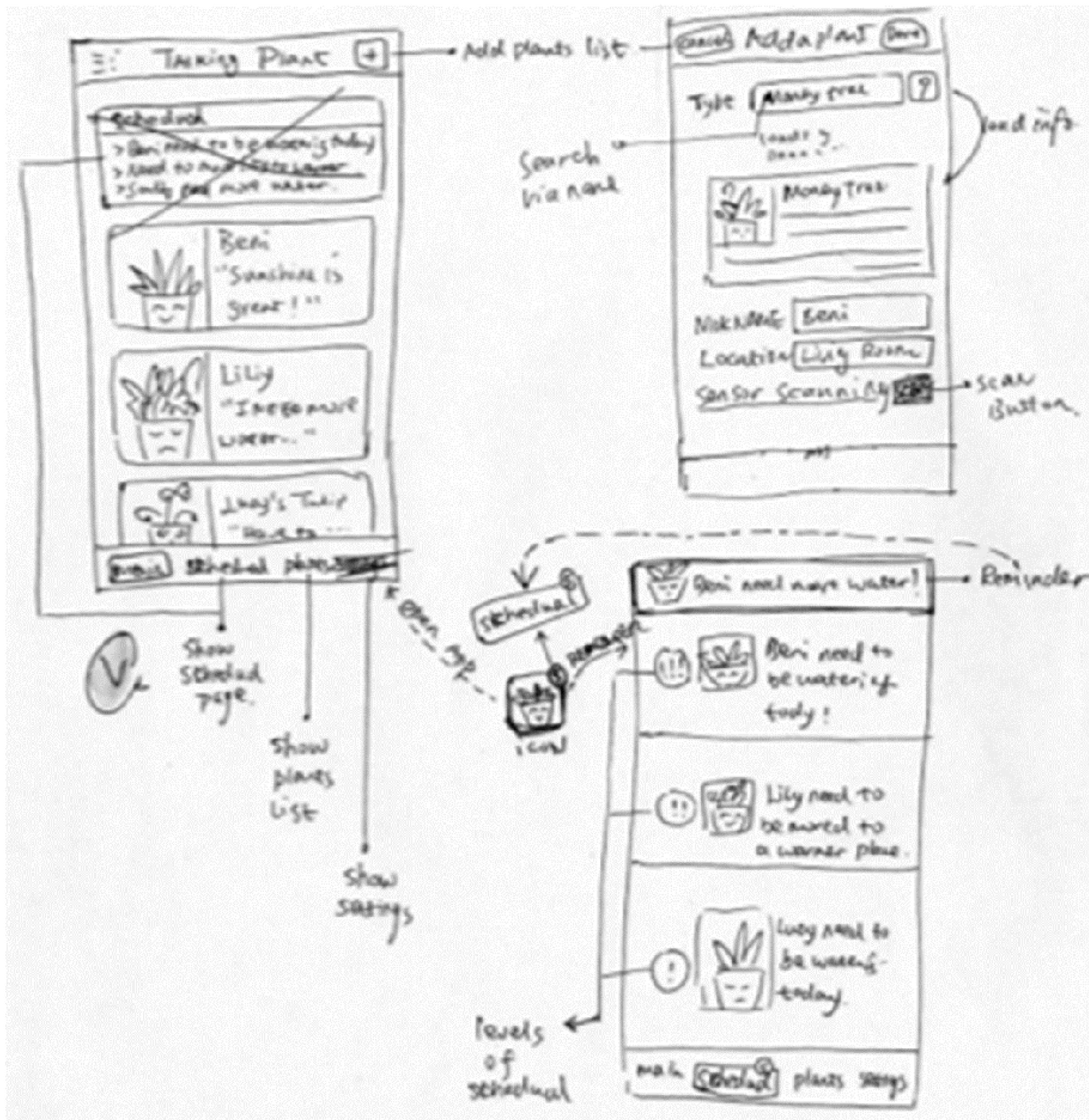
Sketches (2a)



Sketches (2e)

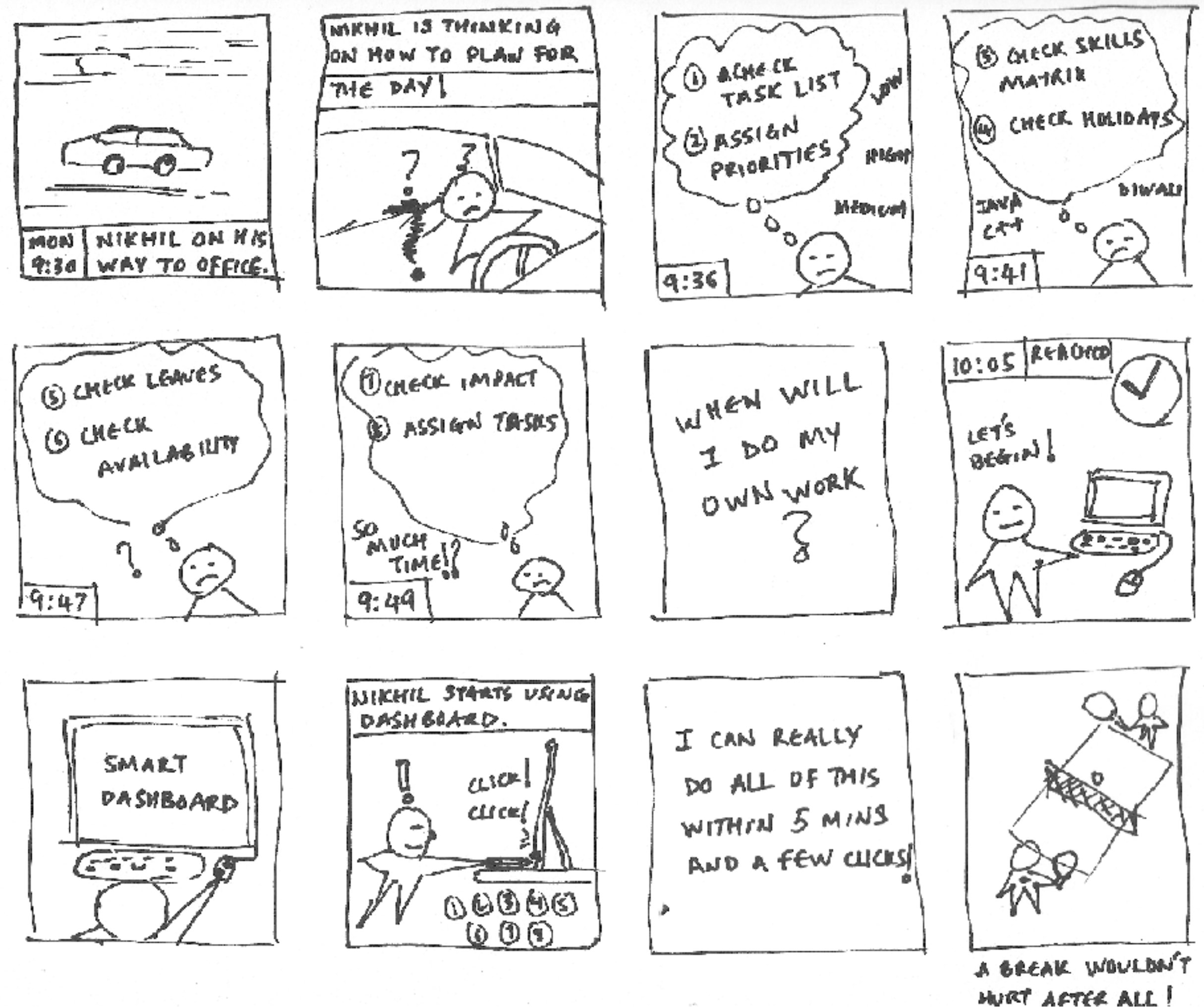
SCENARIO 1 "I want to listen to alternative music"



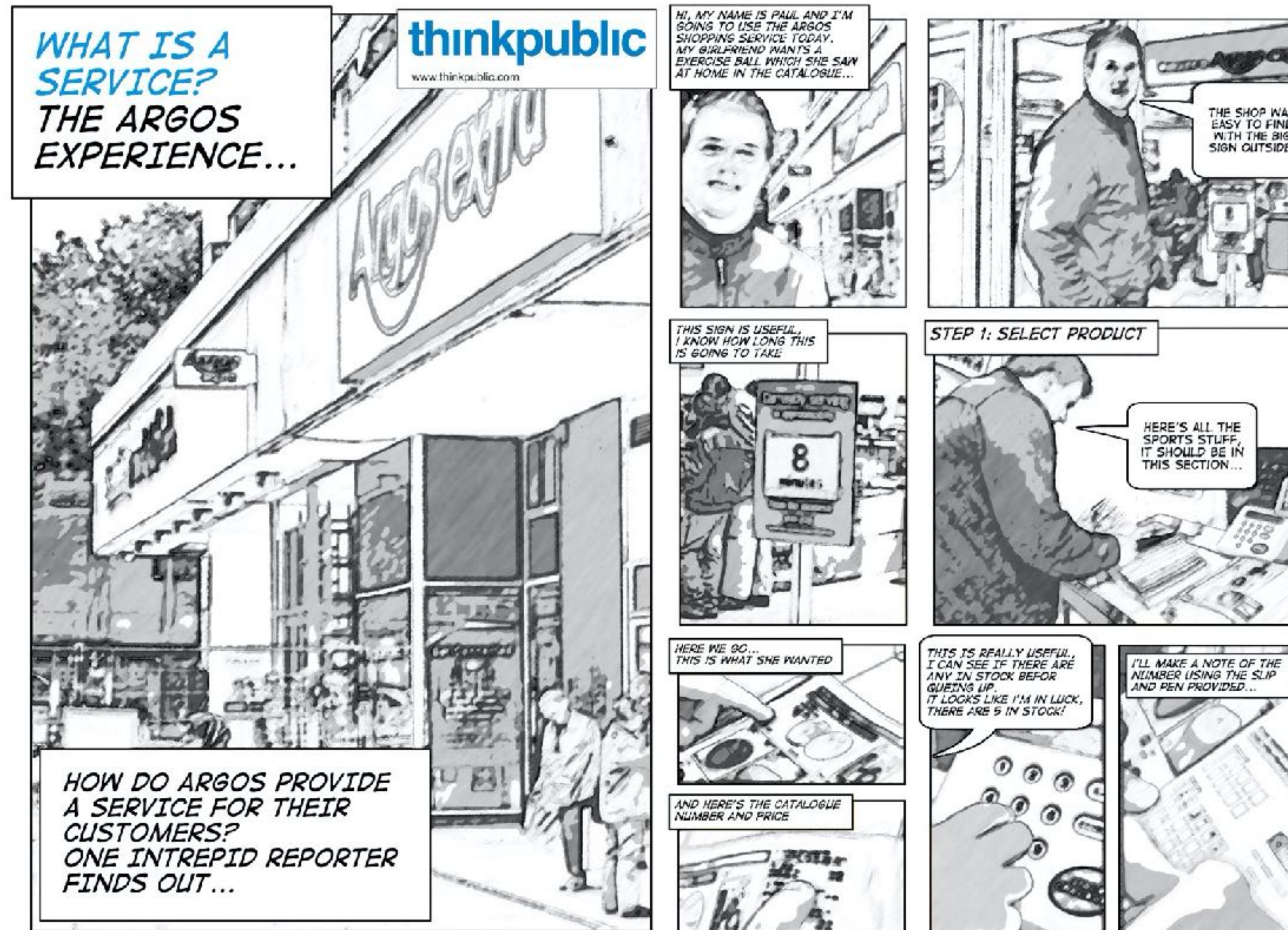


Sketches (2e)

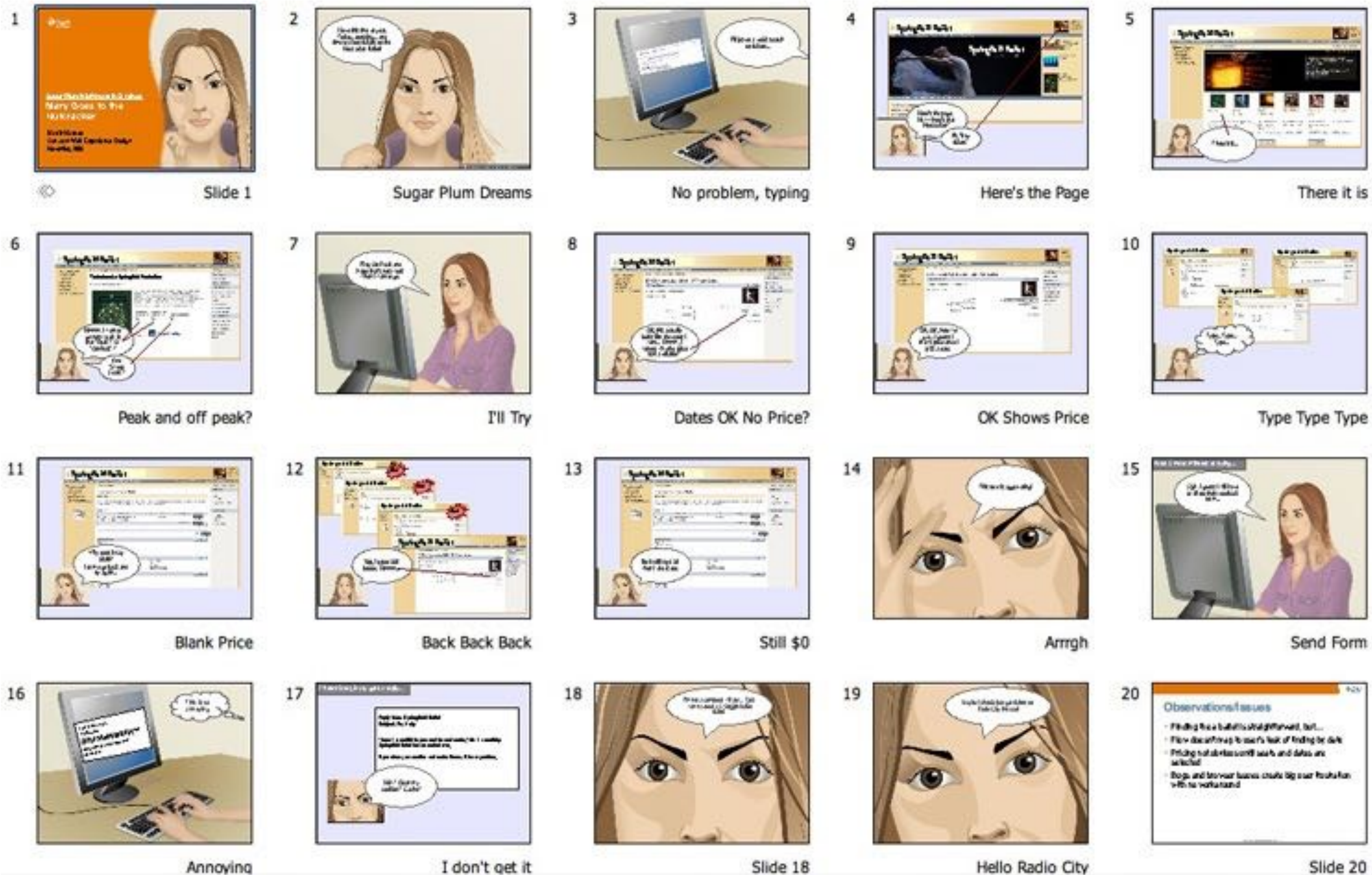
And finally... a storyboard! (2f)



Storyboards (2f)



Storyboards (2f)



Storyboards (2f)

altVerto
FROM APATHY
TO ADVOCACY

AFTER A LONG WORKDAY, JEN DECIDES TO CHECK TRAFFIC BEFORE HEADING HOME...

UGH! YOU'VE GOT TO BE KIDDING.

I'D RATHER WAIT THAN DRIVE IN THIS.

HUH... THEY'RE PROMOTING SOME SORT OF TRANSIT PLUGIN

WHY DON'T I GIVE IT A SHOT?

ONE WEEK LATER...

HI JEN. WE'RE GOING TO LINDA'S TAVERN FOR DRINKS AROUND 7 TONIGHT. YOU INTERESTED?

SOUNDS GOOD. WHAT'S THE BEST WAY TO DRIVE THERE FROM MY PLACE?

NOT SURE... JUST GOOGLE IT.

WILL DO. CYA LATER.

ALTVERTO SUGGESTS: TAKE THE BUS AND SAVE MONEY!

HUH, I DIDN'T KNOW THIS ROUTE.

THE BUS IT IS THEN.

A MONTH GOES BY...

ACCORDING TO ALTVERTO, I'VE SAVED A LOT OF MONEY BY TAKING THE BUS.

IT'S A SHAME THAT THERE AREN'T CONVENIENT BUS ROUTES FOR MY COMMUTE

AREN'T YOU ALWAYS TELLING ME ABOUT YOUR WEEKEND BIKE RIDES?

WHY NOT BIKE?

MAYBE... I'D HAVE TO GET SOME ADVICE AND FIGURE OUT A GOOD ROUTE FIRST.

Enter your discussion topic
Bike commuting tips?

Enter your comments
Hi! After finding out that there's a good bike route to work, I've plunge, and was wondering if you could pass along some tips for
Specifically, I'm curious about
- work clothes that are
- best messenger bag
- arriving and not

SEEMS LIKE THE ALTVERTO CYCLING FORUM IS A GOOD PLACE TO START.

LATER THAT SAME YEAR...

Good bike repair shops on Capitol Hill?
mackenzie89

Need help figuring out safe bus route
District to Fremont?
ridefreezone

Special critical mass tomorrow in s
downtown bike lanes!
ballardoct

What's your favorite fun ride on the eastside?
nwhiker

MORE BIKE LANES DOWNTOWN WOULD MAKE MY COMMUTE A LOT SAFER. I SHOULD DO THE CRITICAL MASS RIDE.

Field trial participants not only reported changing their behavior - reducing single occupant trips by around 10% - but they also told us about encouraging their peers and colleagues to do so during and after the field trial.

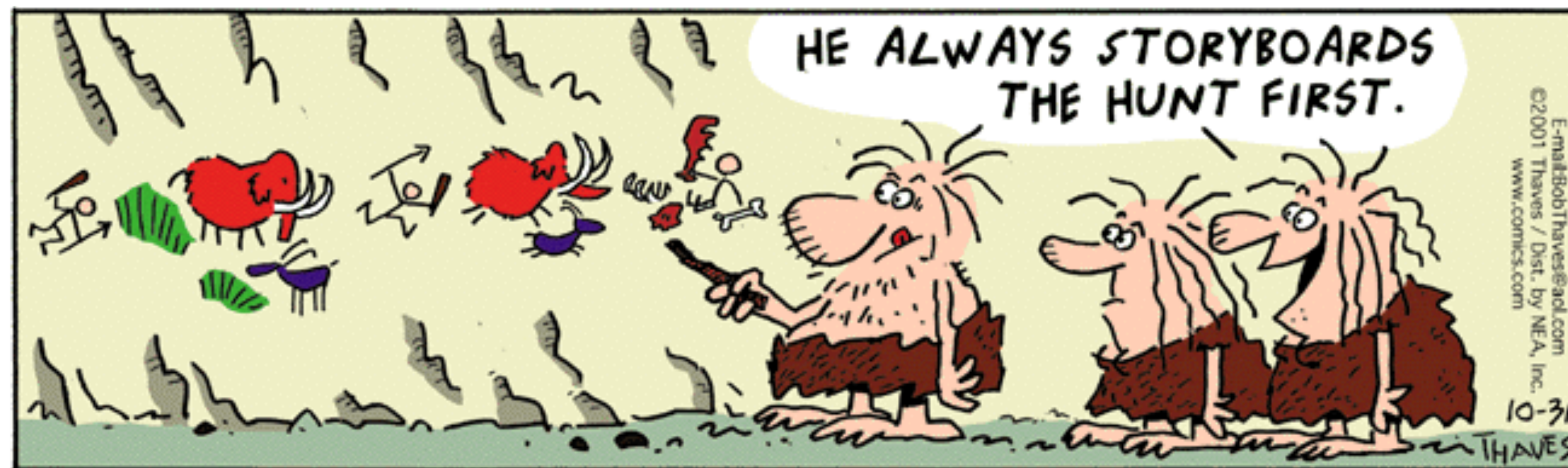
seattle critical mass images from flickr user timmycorkery

Why Storyboards if you have Scenarios?

- They help you think more deeply about...
 - Specific details about the environments where the system is used
 - Physical constraints (size of system, space where it's used)
 - Relationship among multiple people
 - Feelings and concerns of people

Illustrating Time

- Storyboards come from film and animation
- Give a “script” of important events
 - leave out the details
 - concentrate on the important interactions



Allowing Exploration

- Still relatively fast and inexpensive to produce
 - Can explore more potential approaches
- Notes help fill in missing pieces of the proposal



Effective to communicate

- Effective storyboards can quickly convey information that would be difficult to understand in text
- Imagine explaining the storyboard on the right in text, for various audiences



5 considerations in a storyboard

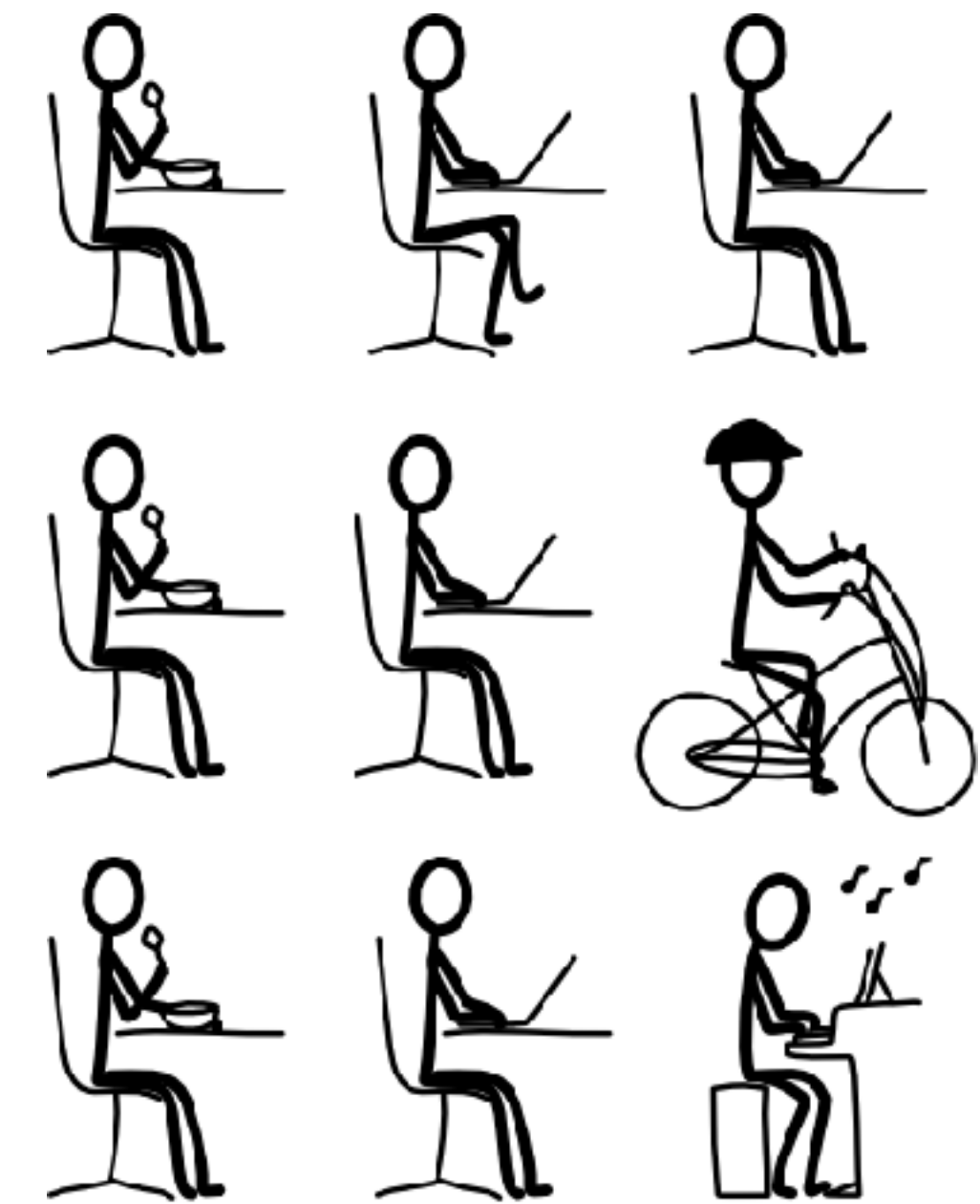
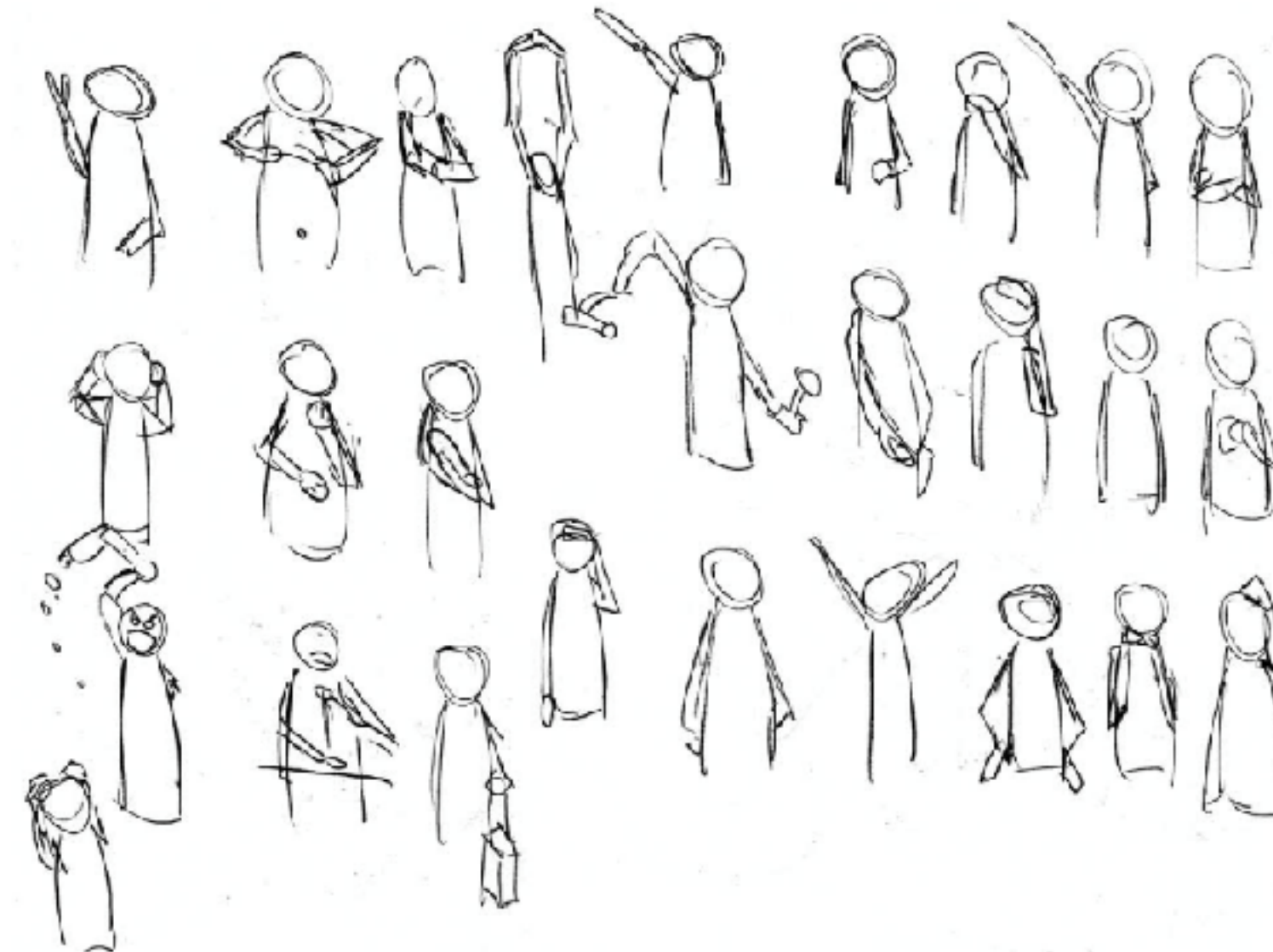
5 Considerations in a Storyboard

1. Level of detail
2. Inclusion of text
3. Inclusion of people and emotions
4. Number of frames
5. Portrayal of time

Truong, Khai N., Gillian R. Hayes, and Gregory D. Abowd. "Storyboarding: an empirical determination of best practices and effective guidelines." *Proceedings of the 6th conference on Designing Interactive systems*. 2006.

1. Level of detail

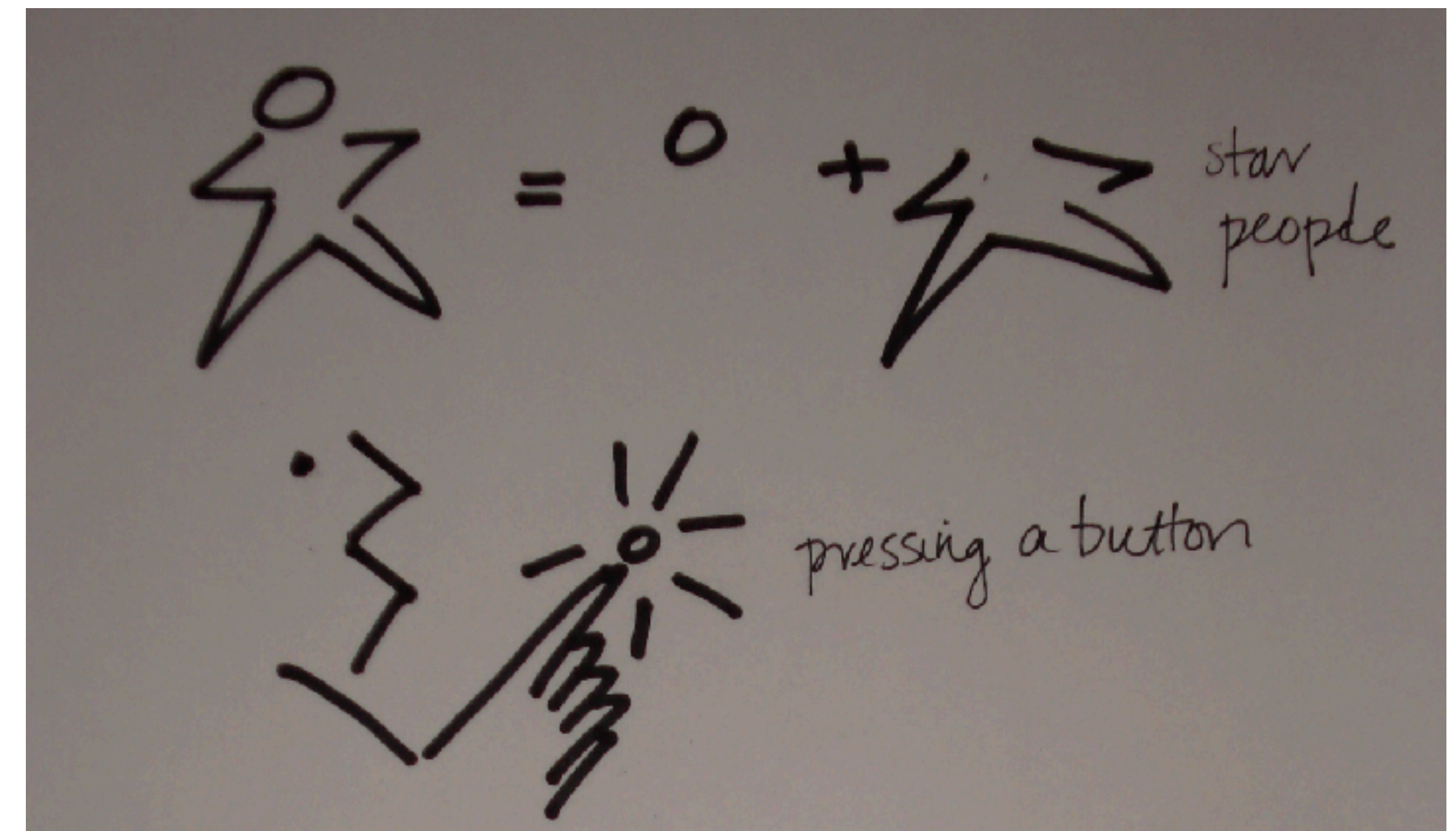
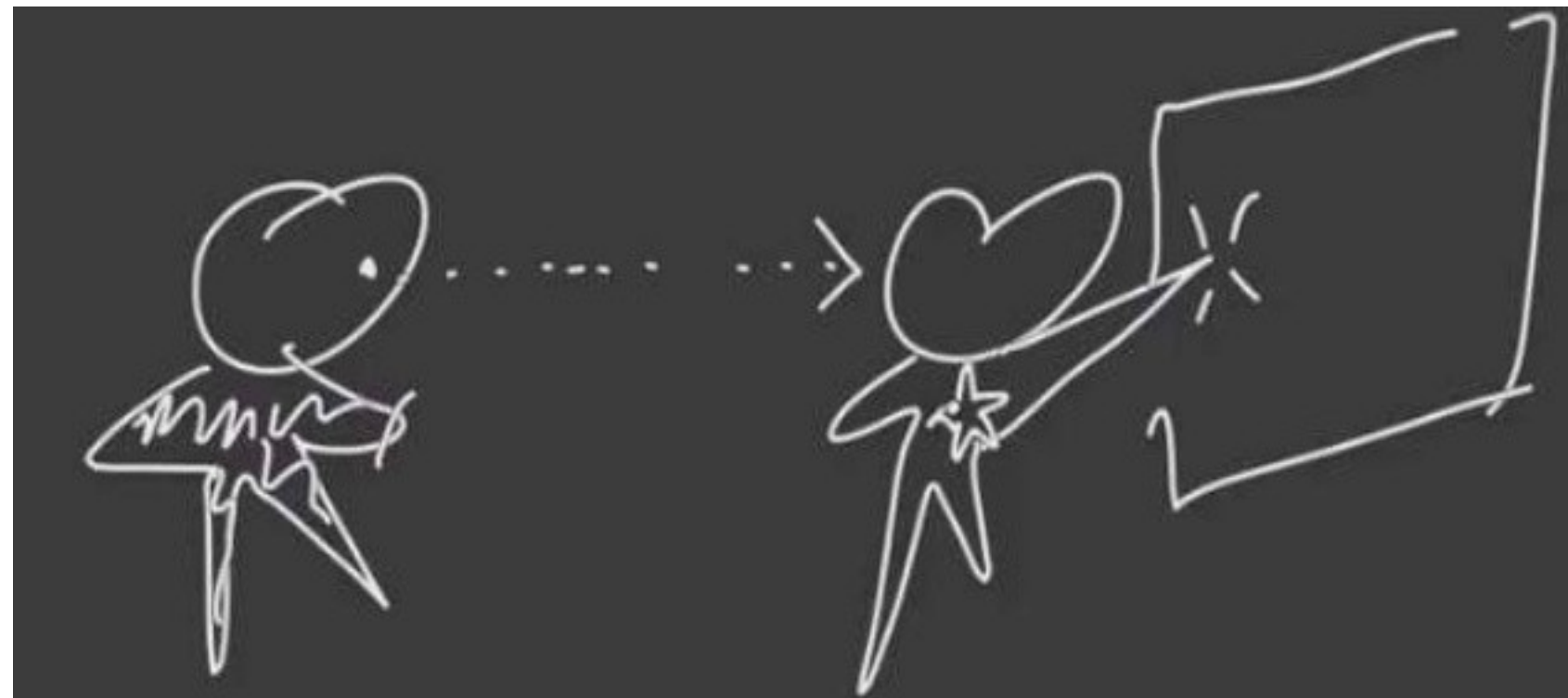
- Guideline: too much detail can lose universality
- How to draw people?



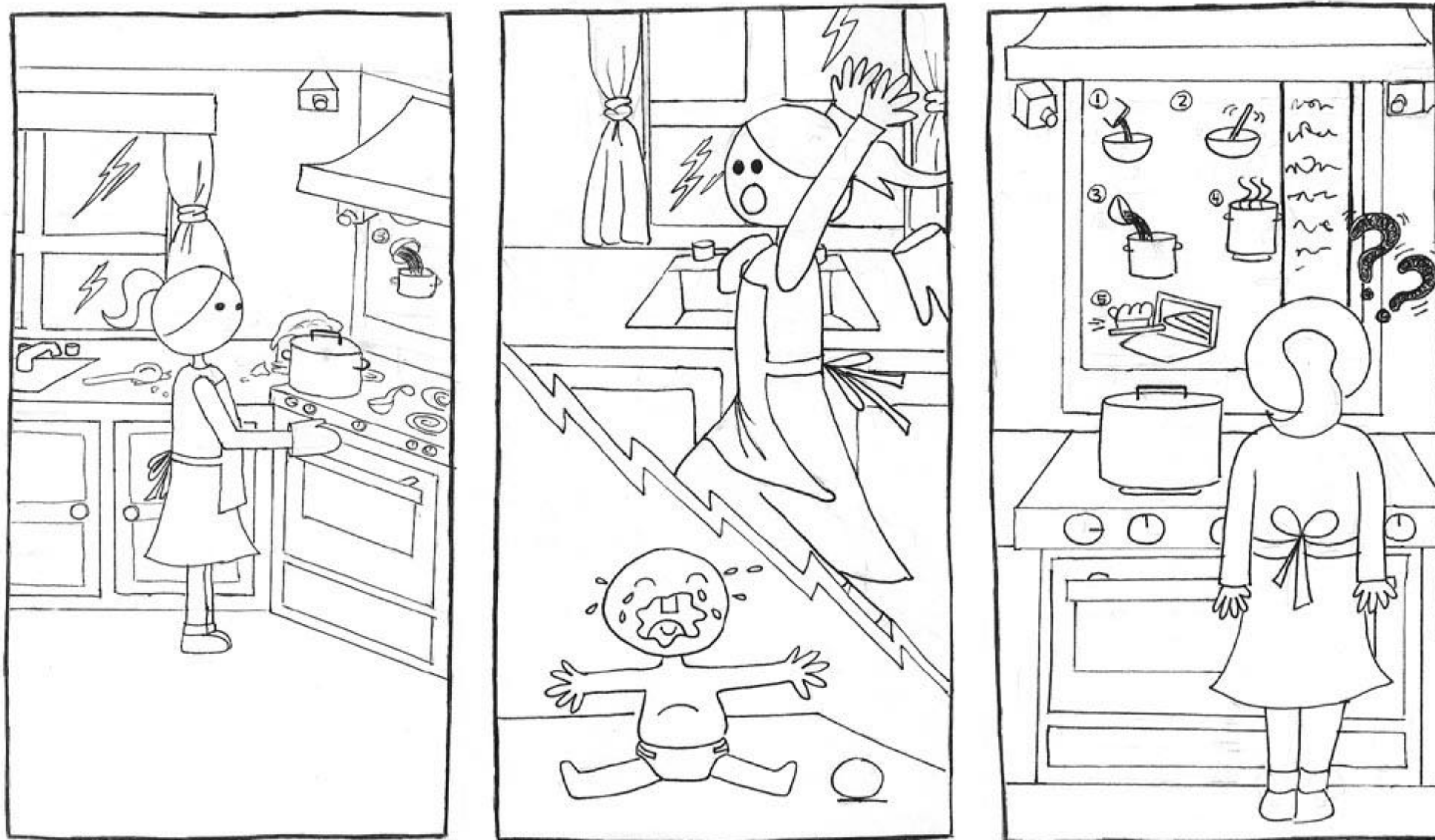
(c) 2009 SACHA CHUA

1. Level of detail

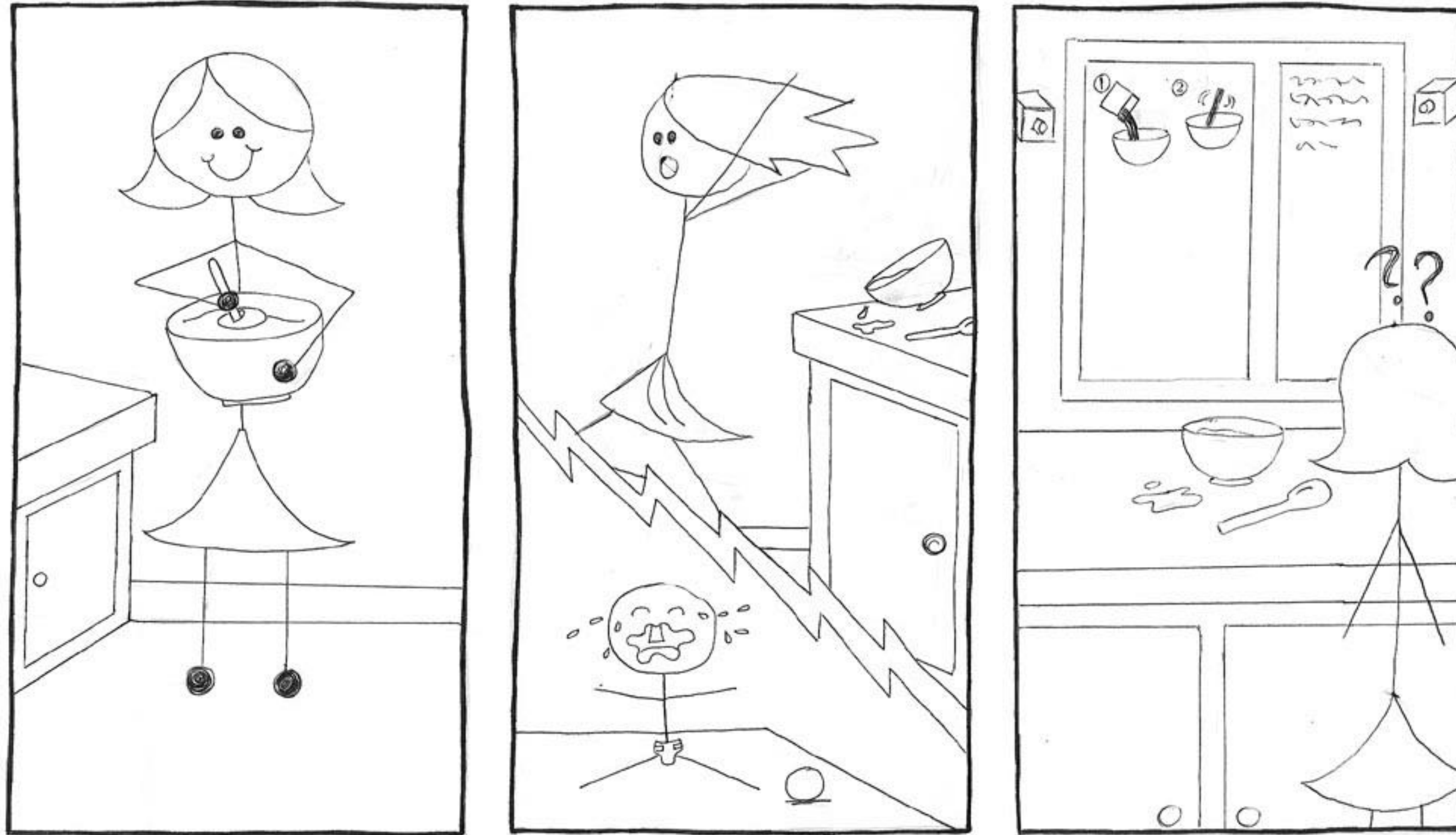
- How to easily indicate pointing or pressing



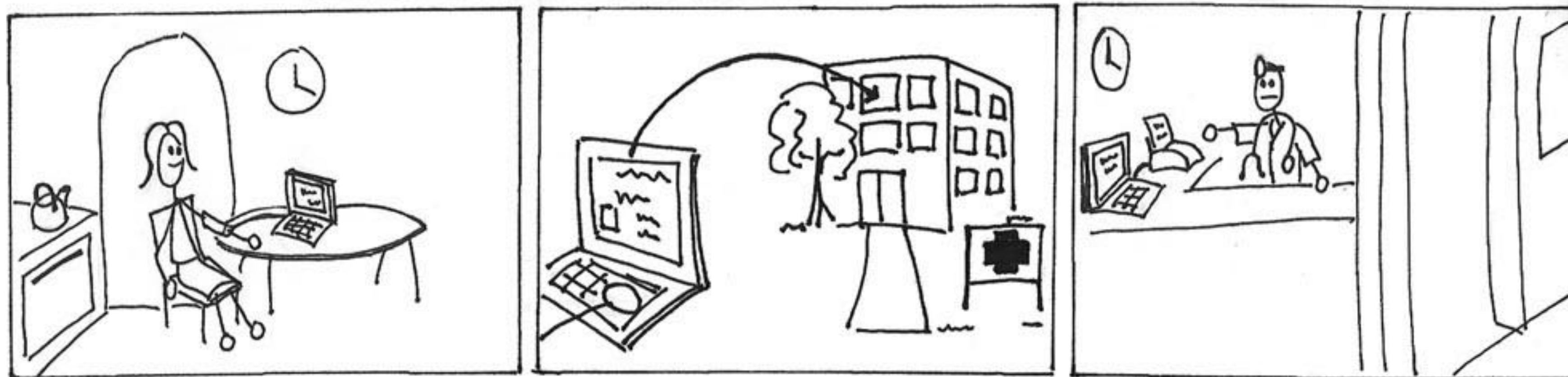
1. Level of detail



1. Level of detail

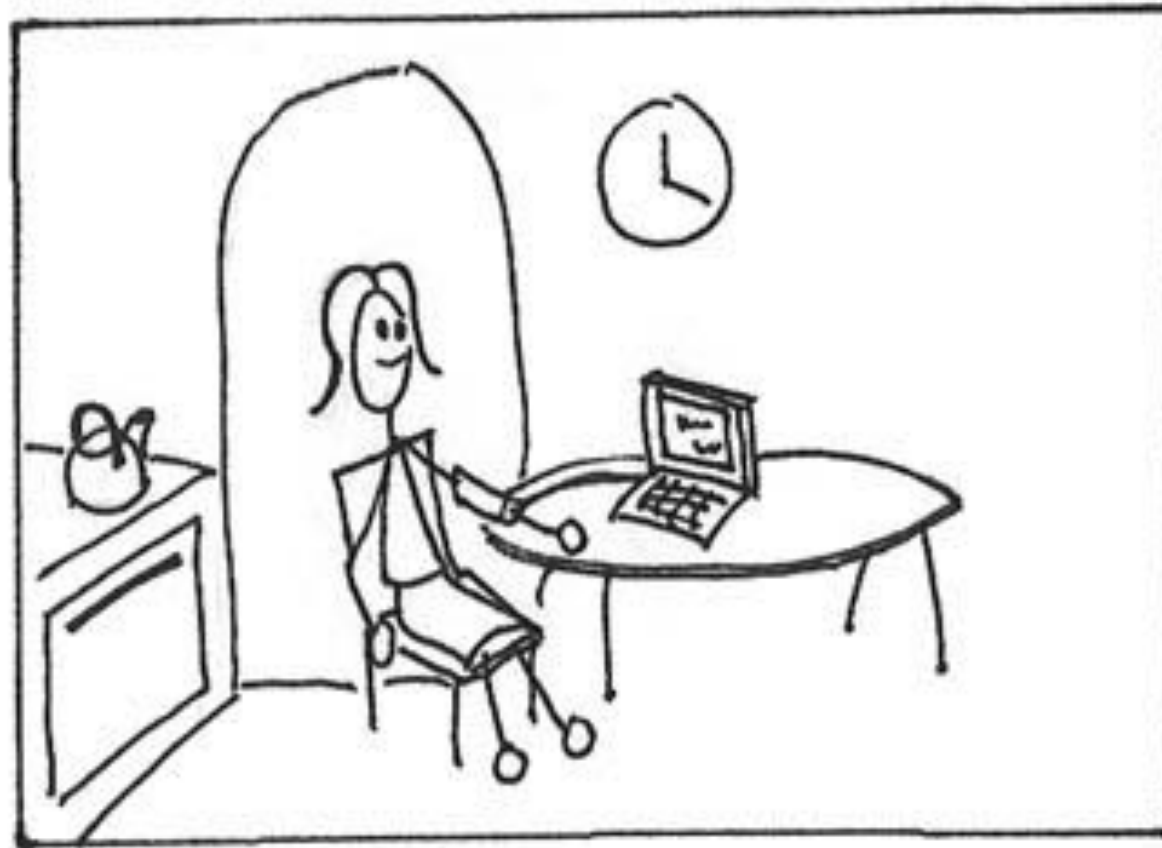


2. Inclusion of Text

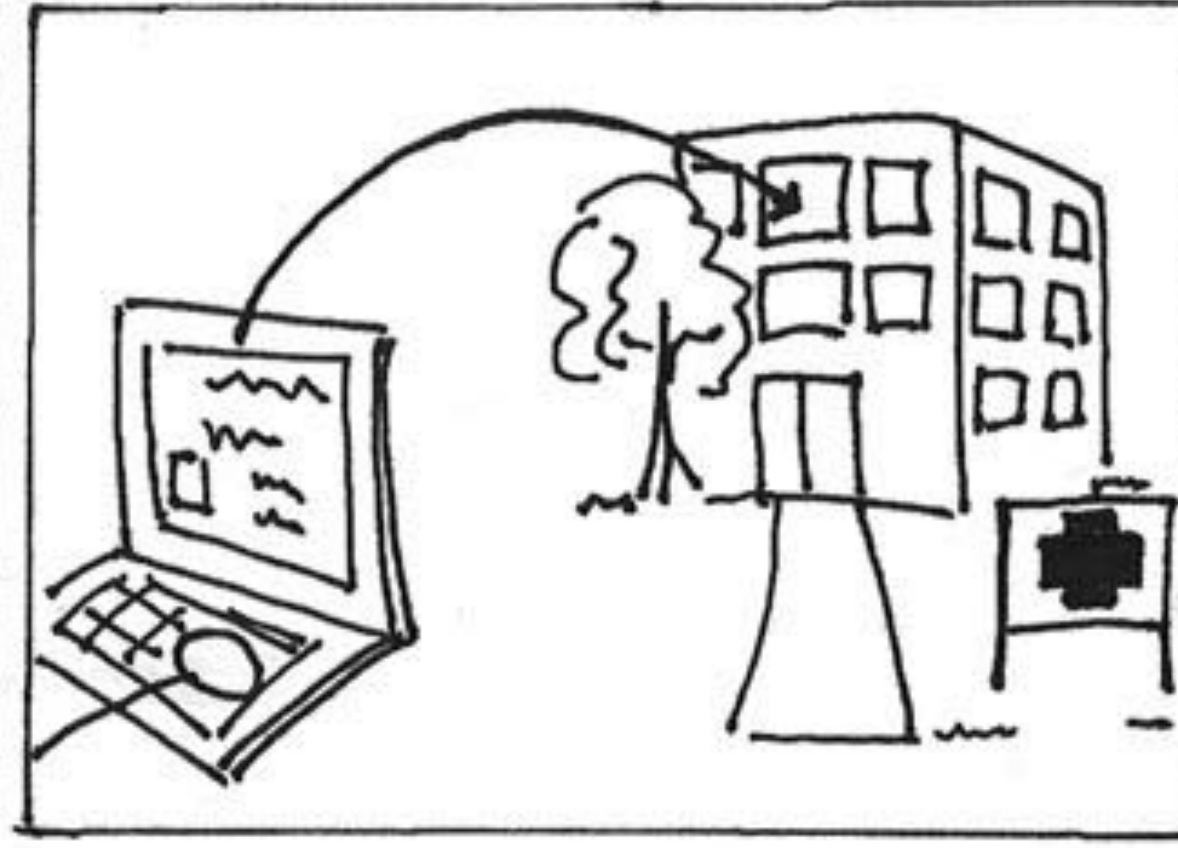


2. Inclusion of Text

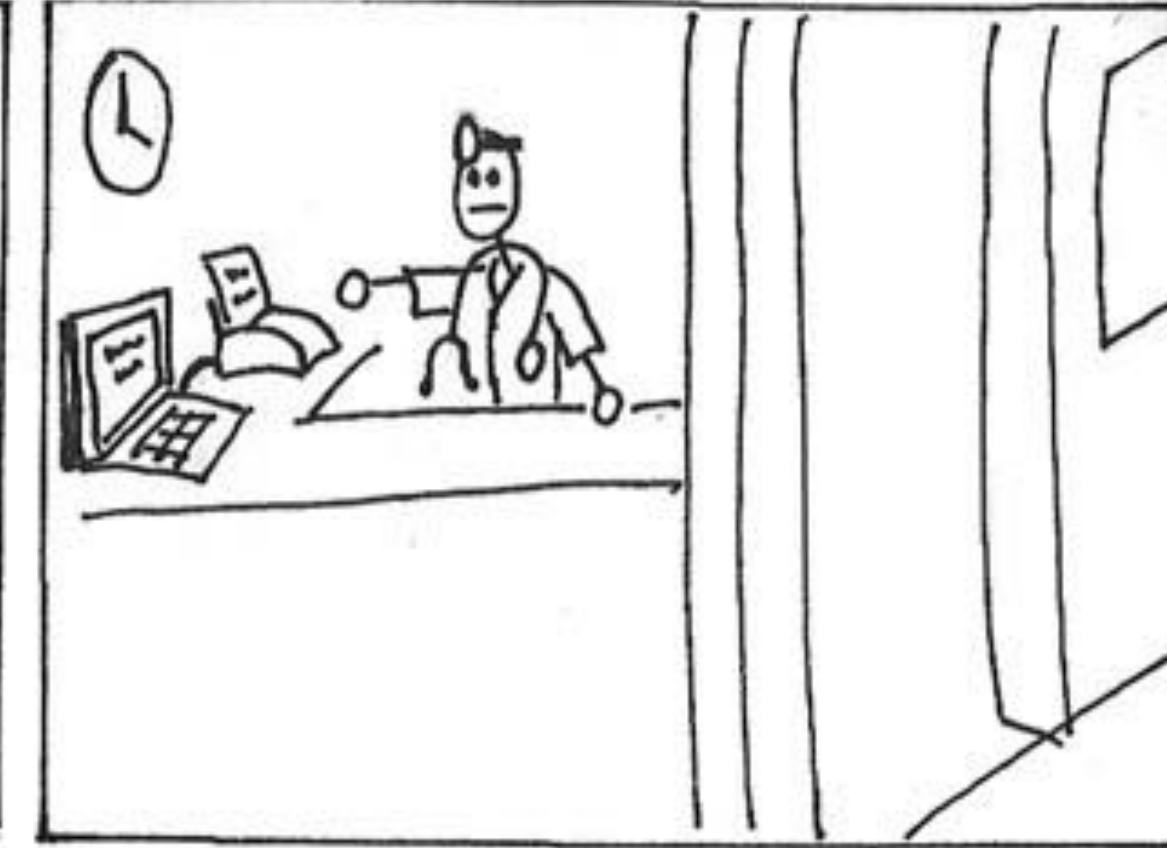
- Guideline: text is often necessary—but keep it short!



1. At home, Mary checks her blood pressure.



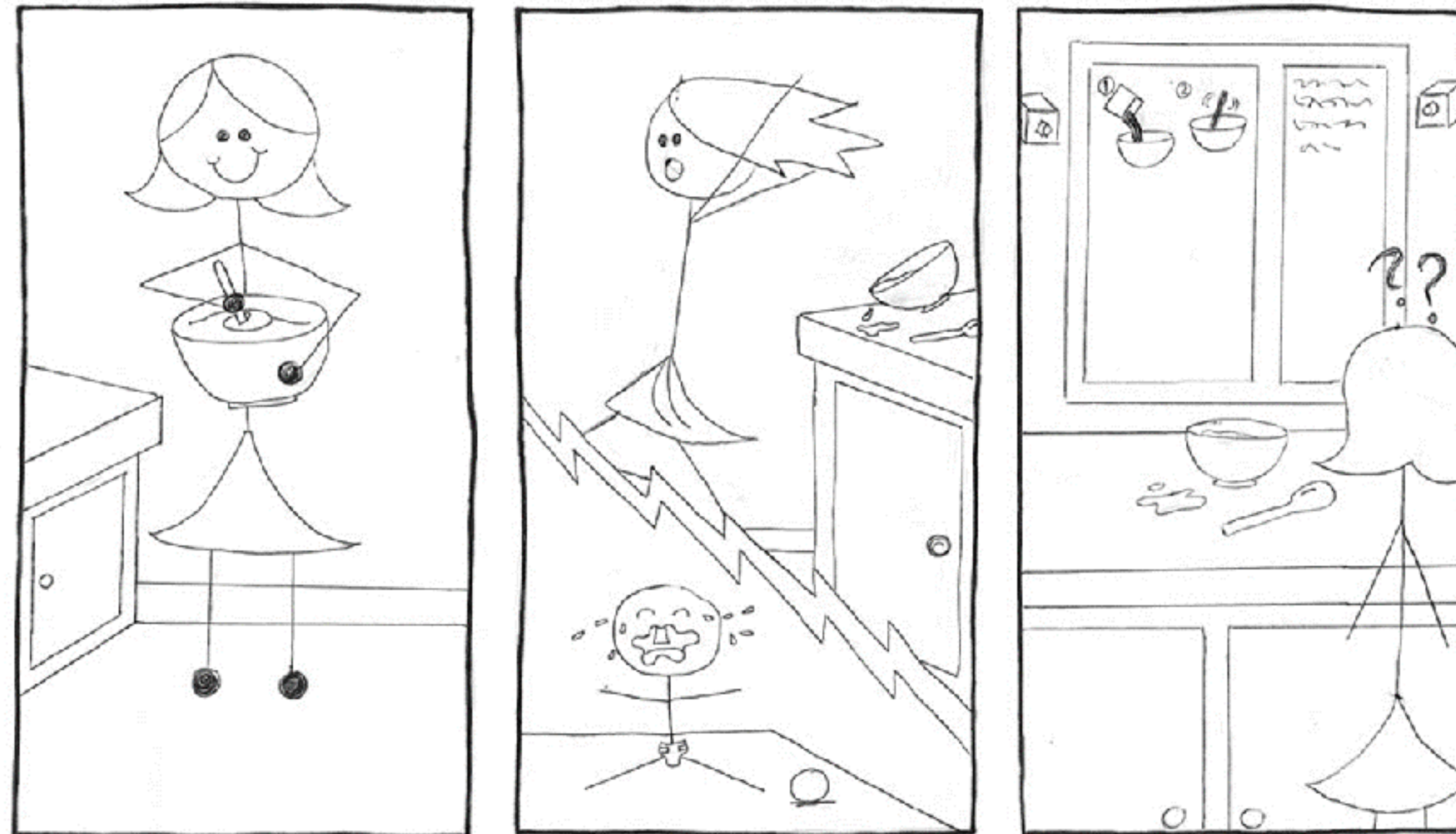
2. After a few simple key presses, her blood pressure readings get sent to a clinic.



3. The information is made available to her doctor.

3. Inclusion of People and Emotions

- Guideline: Include people experiencing the design and their reactions to it (good or bad)
- Remember, the point of storyboards is to convey the experience of using the system.

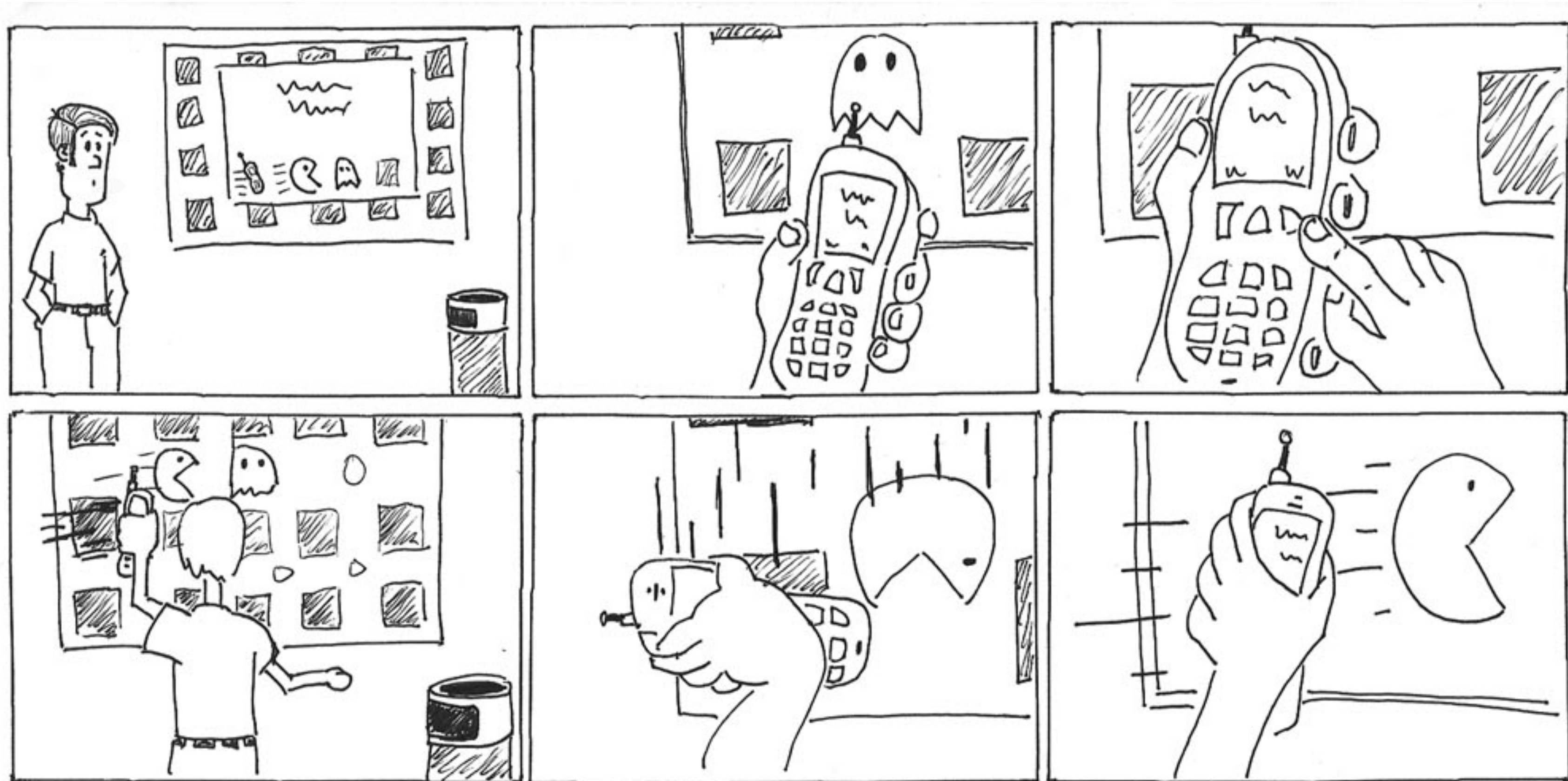


4. How Many Frames?

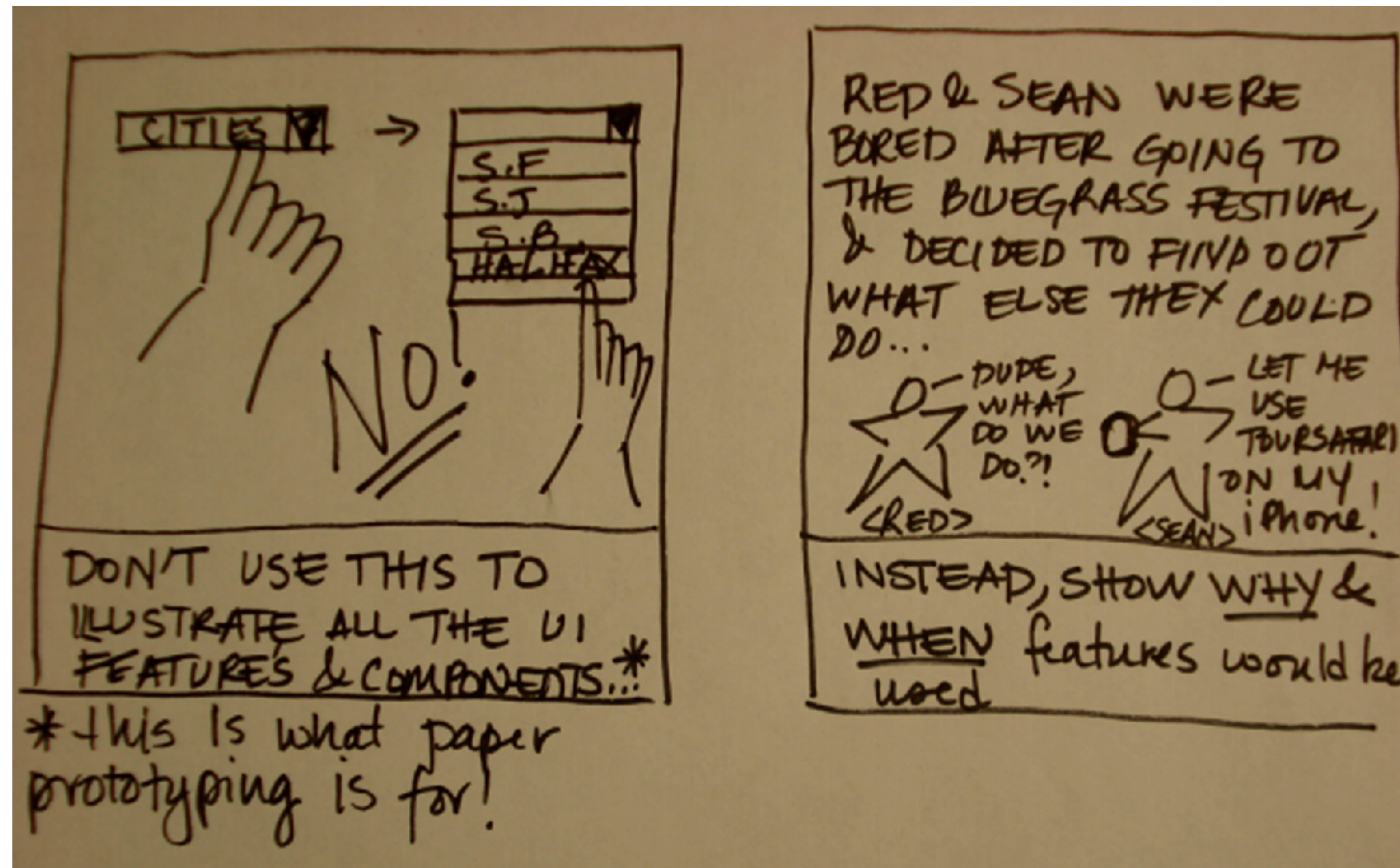
- Guideline: 4-6 frames per scenario is ideal for end-users
 - Less work to illustrate
 - Must be able to succinctly tell story
 - Potentially longer for design clients
- More is not always better
 - May lose focus of story
 - May lose attention

4. How Many Frames?

- Guideline: Remove unnecessary frames

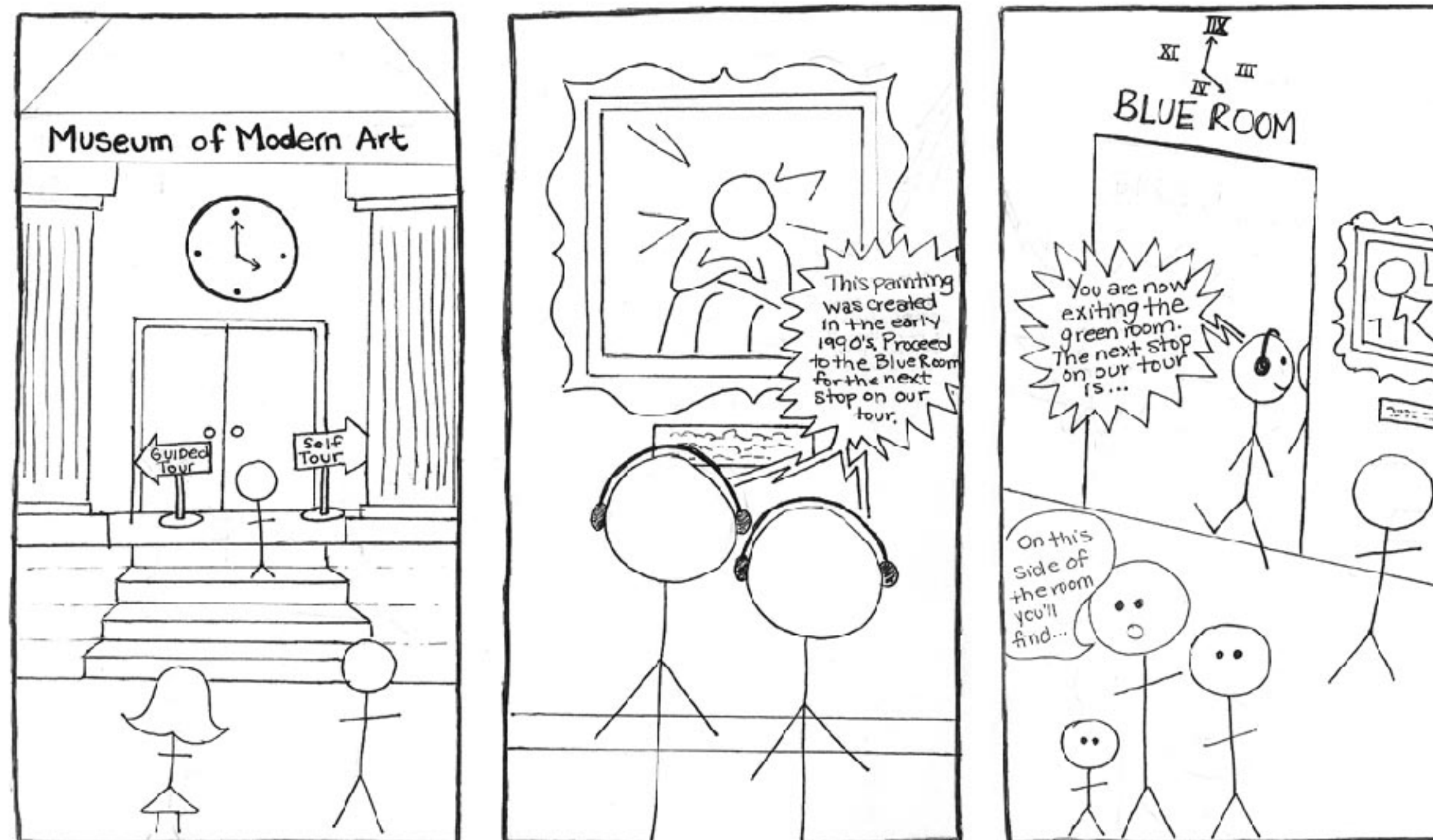


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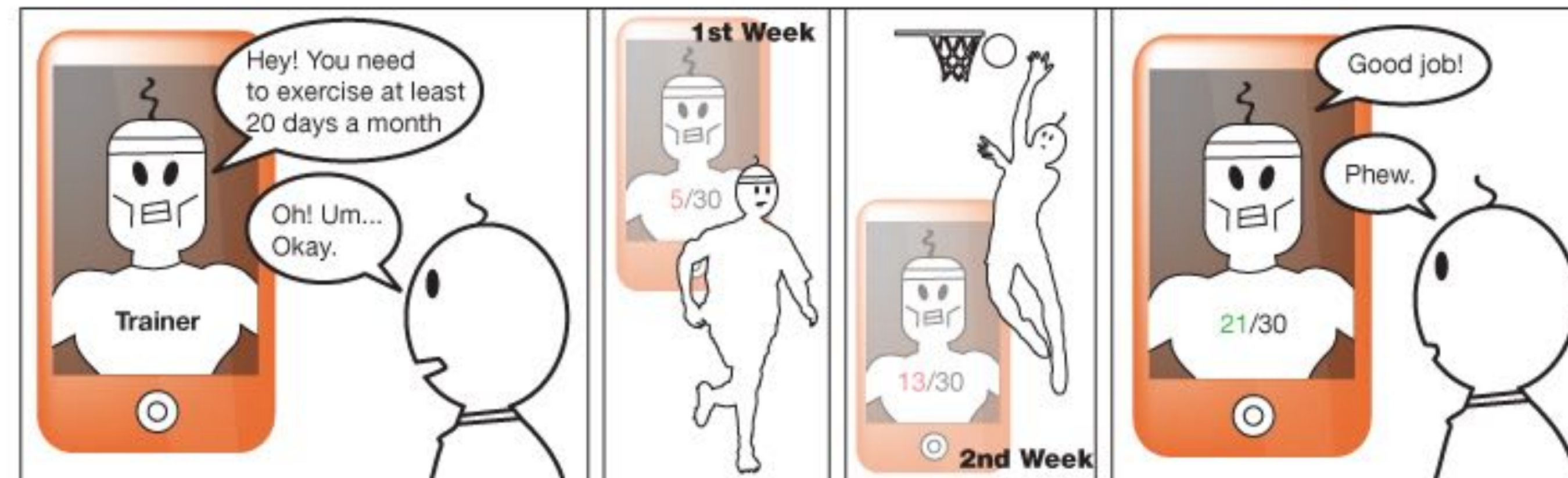
5. Passage of Time

- Guideline: Don't need explicit indicators since assumption is that time is going by, unless you need to show how much time has gone by.



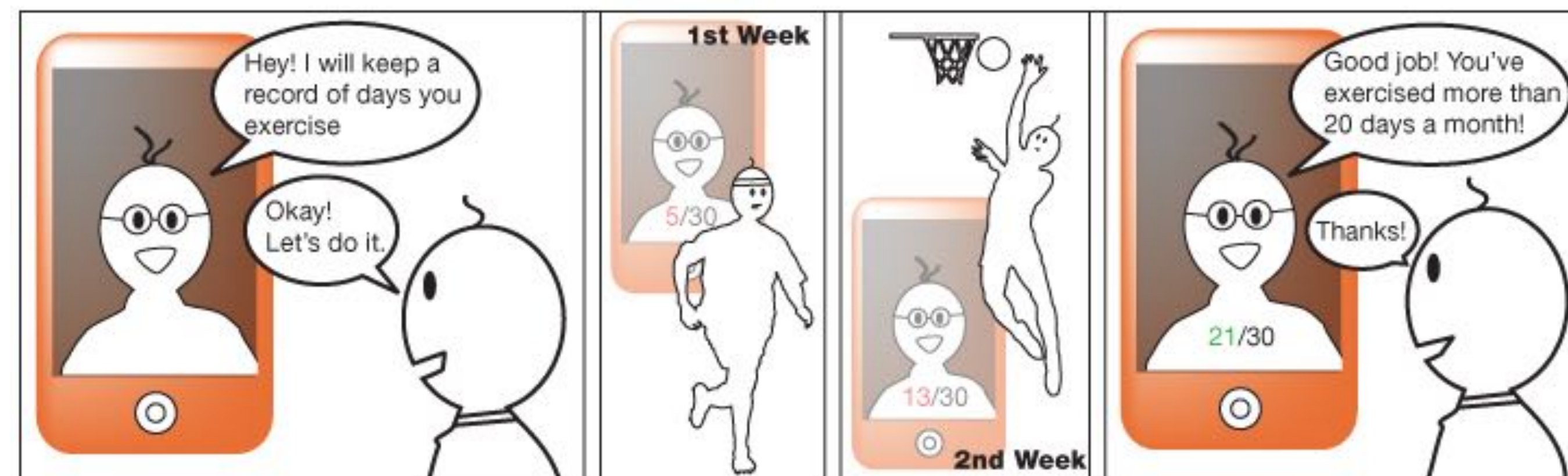
Storyboards for Comparing Ideas

Authoritative



Cell phone is used to keep track of one's fitness goal.

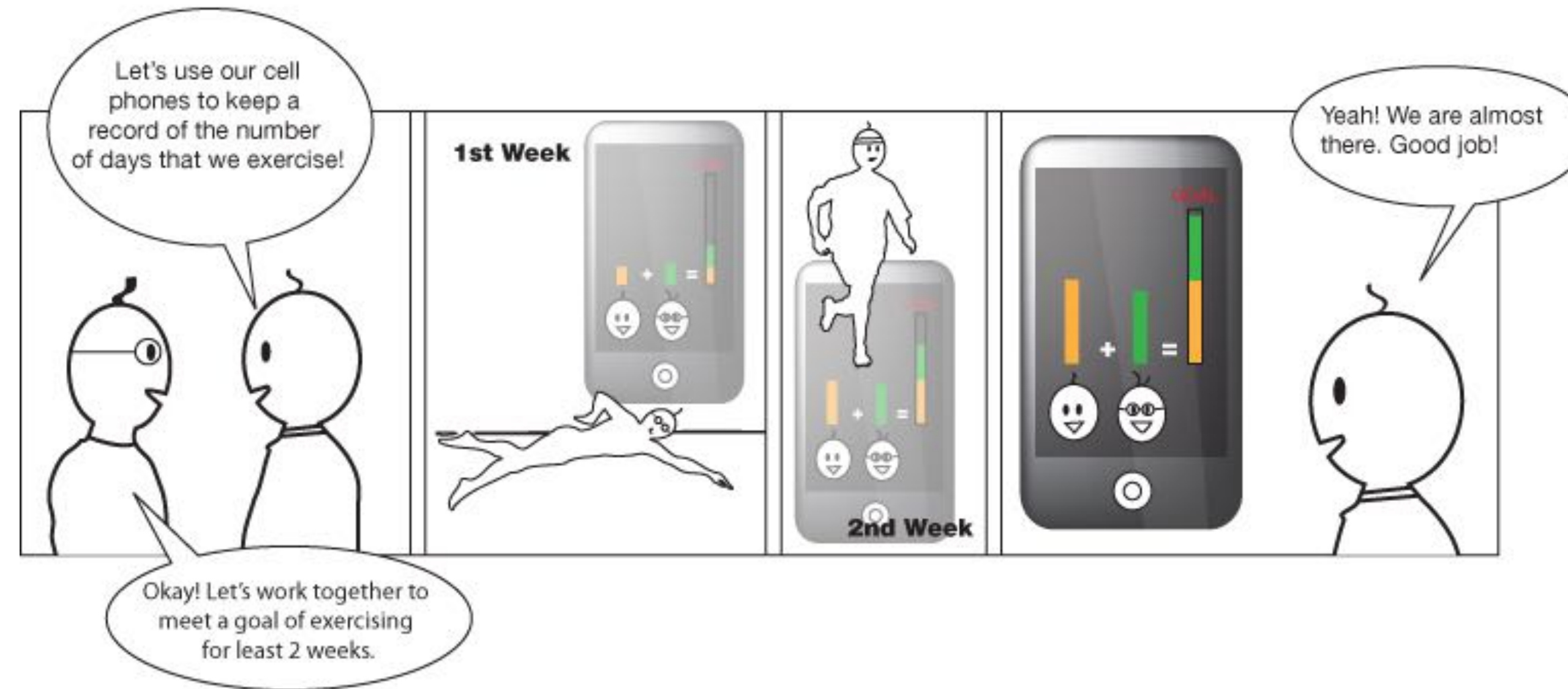
Supportive



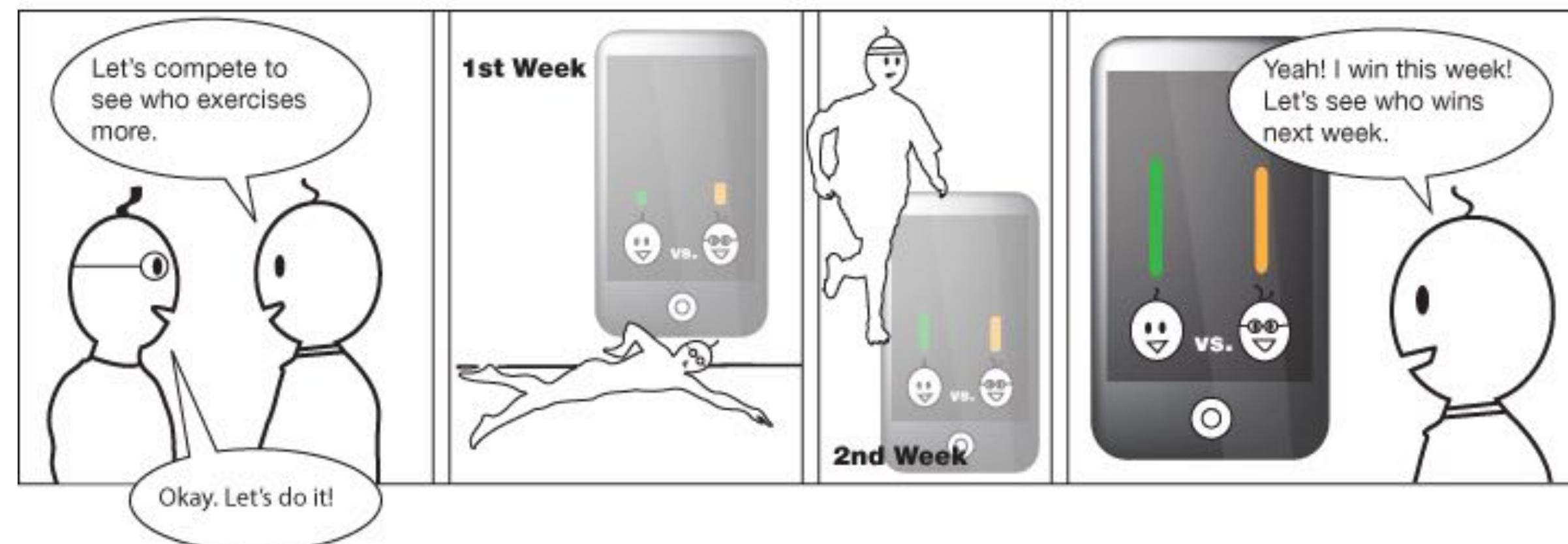
Cell phone is used to keep track of one's fitness goal.

Storyboards for Comparing Ideas

Cooperative



Competitive



Tips and Tricks for Storyboarding

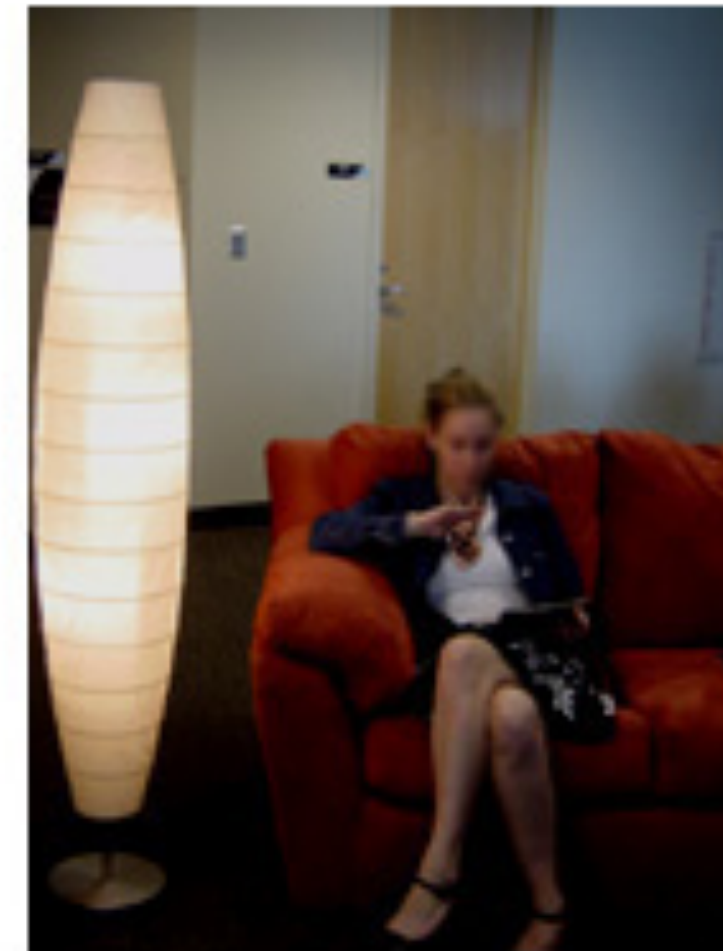
You can use photos (only if really necessary)



IT IS SO DARK JANE CAN
HARDLY READ HER BOOK



SHE GESTURES IN FRONT OF HER
SPECIAL PENDANT TO TURN ON
THE LIGHTS



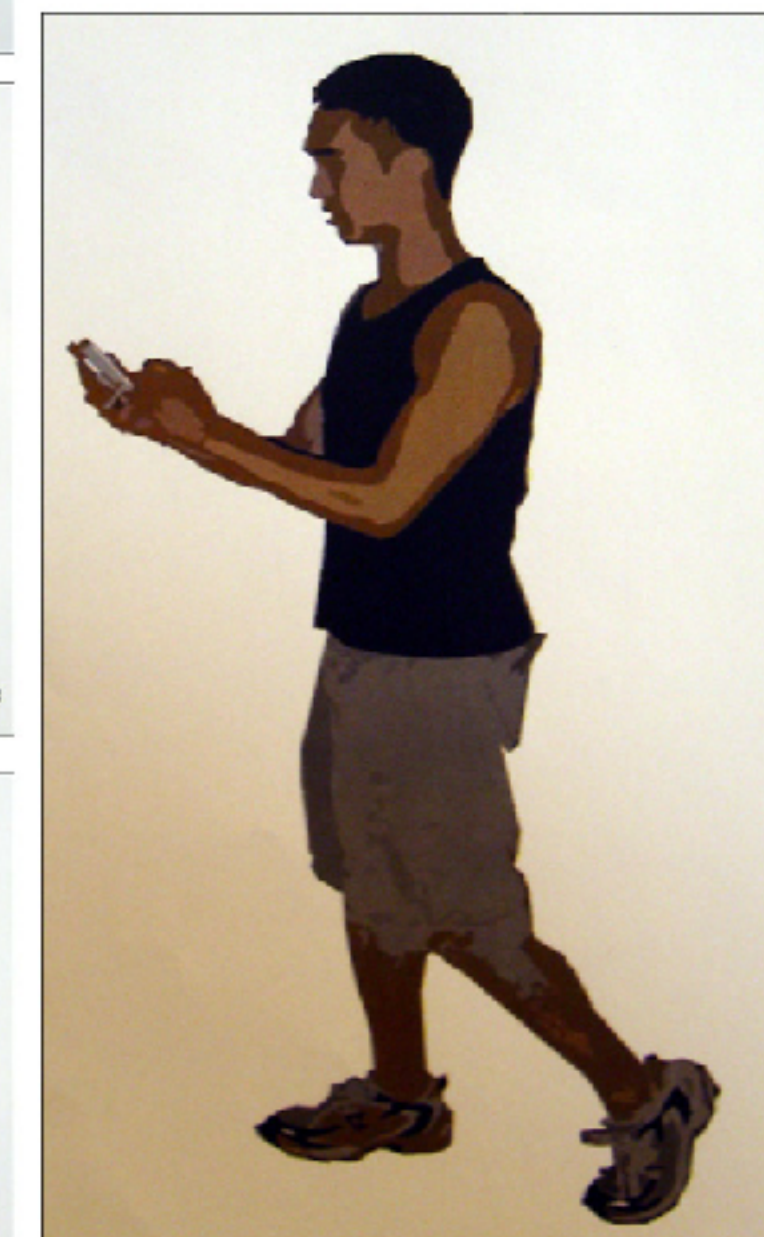
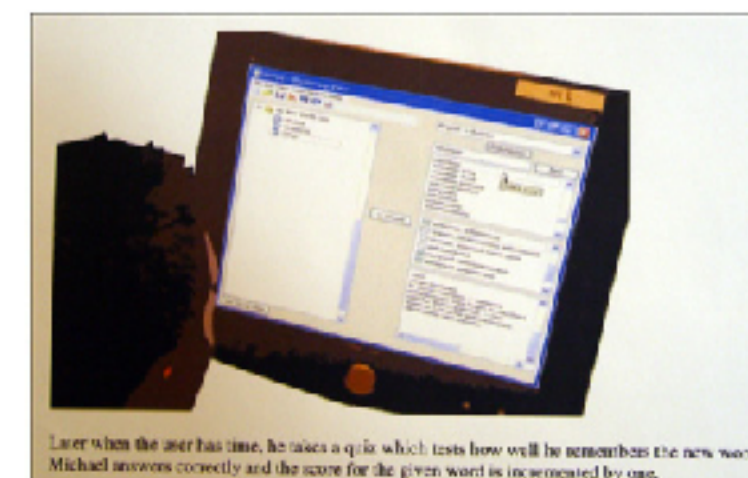
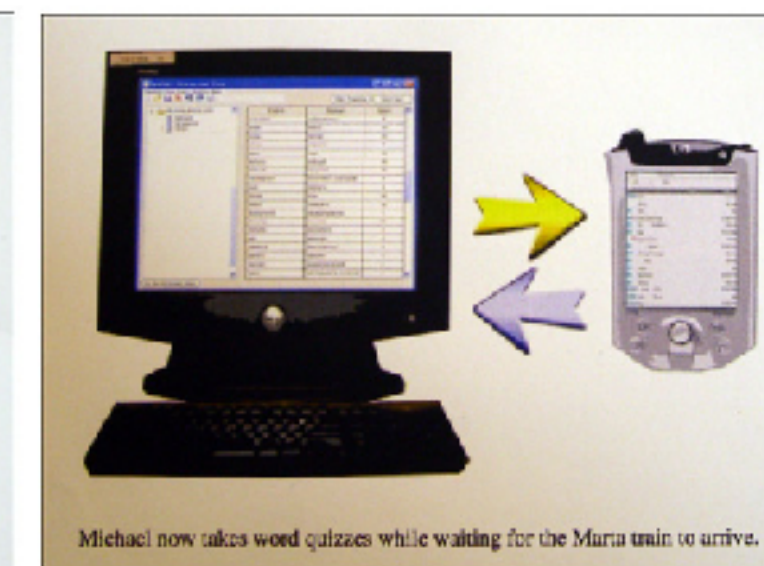
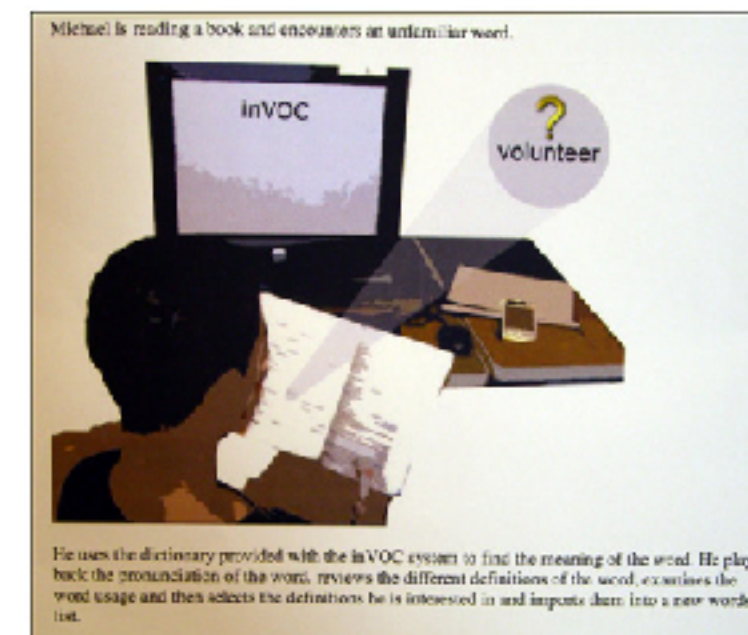
THE LIGHTS TURN ON!



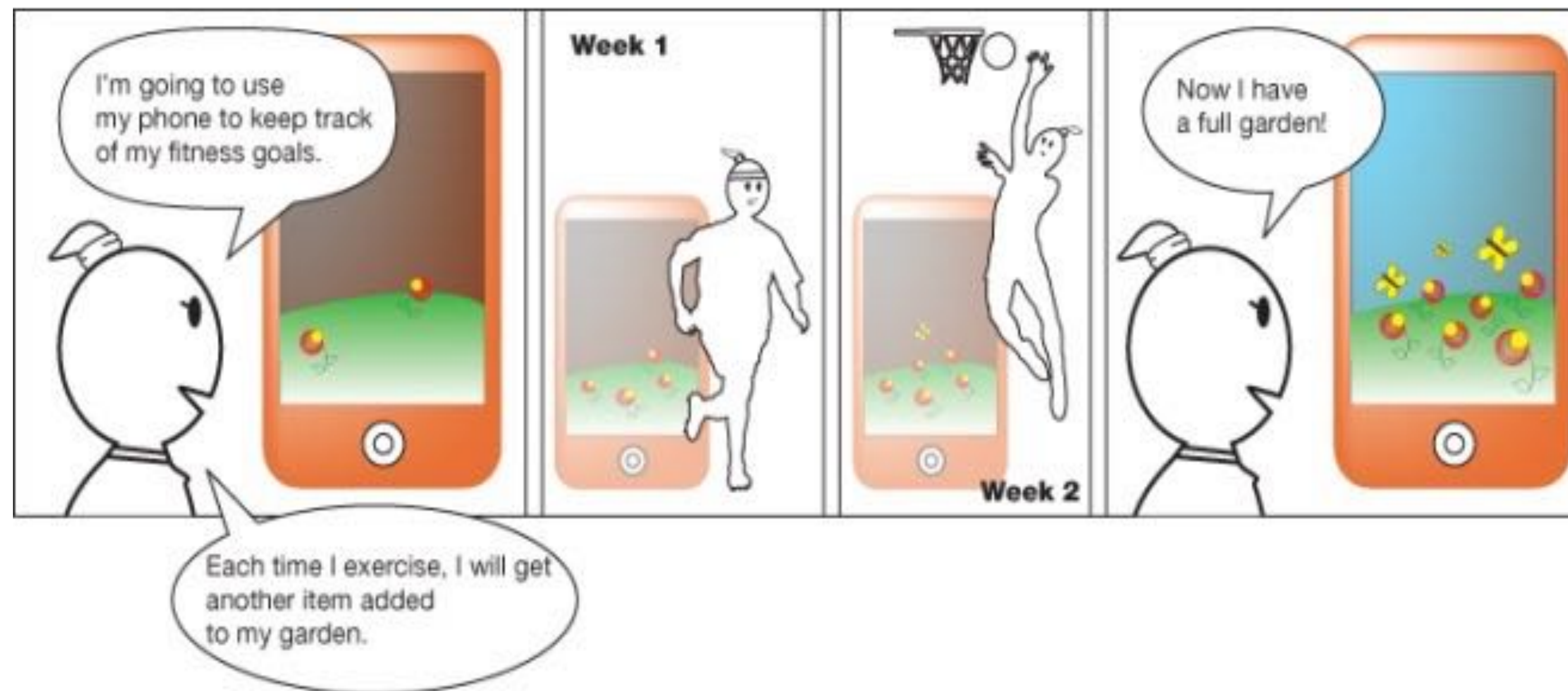
FINALLY, SHE CAN
READ HAPPILY.

Blur Out Unnecessary Detail

Using image editing software to simplify photos into sketches



Use existing images from other sources



<http://designcomics.org>
<http://www.pdclipart.org>
<https://thenounproject.com>

Selective use of color

